From *Texts and Studies in Eastern Christianity*, volume 16
Armenia between Byzantium and the Orient,
Celebrating the Memory of Karen Yuzbashyan (1927-2009),
multiple editors (Boston, 2020).

CHAPTER 21

Byzantine Historiography and the Supposedly Lost Books of Ammianus Marcellinus

Warren Treadgold

Books I–XIII of Ammianus Marcellinus' *Res Gestae*, which covered the years from 96 to 353, are missing from our manuscripts and generally believed to be wholly lost, except for a few references that Ammianus himself makes to them in his surviving Books XIV–XXXI. Yet much of the supposedly lost books probably survives in Greek summaries. Ammianus' Books I–XXV were apparently summarized in the early sixth century by Eustathius of Epiphania for his *Chronological Epitome*, which was quickly copied with fictional elaborations by John Malalas for his *General History*, then faithfully copied again in the early seventh century by John of Antioch for his *Chronological History*. John of Antioch's work, which survives today in extensive fragments, was in its turn used by John Zonaras in the twelfth century, Theodore Scutariotes in the thirteenth century, and other Byzantine historians, who thus drew indirectly on Books I–XIII of Ammianus. Ammianus' main sources for these books seem to have been a brief chronicle including the ages of the emperors at their deaths, the hypothetical Latin *Kaisergeschichte*, the surviving history of Herodian, and the otherwise mostly lost history of the pagan historian Eusebius, who apparently summarized Dexippus. In all, we may have around a fifth of the contents of Ammianus' Books I–XIII.

I

My subject here is an ostensibly lost part of a major source for the history of the Later Roman Empire and its relations with Persia and Armenia, the *Res Gestae* of Ammianus Marcellinus.[1] Our rather corrupt manuscripts of Ammianus'

1 I have tried to limit the length of this already long article by concentrating on the relations of the texts to each other rather than on their reliability as historical sources, by including only essential references to the relevant Byzantine chronicles and secondary literature, and by almost entirely avoiding references to the problematic *Historia Augusta*. The outlines of the present argument were first suggested in W. Treadgold, *The Early Byzantine Historians* (Bas-

history include only Books XIV–XXXI, which cover the years from 353 to 378.[2] We are therefore missing Books I–XIII, which seem originally to have covered the years from 96 to 353, since Ammianus tells us in a postscript that his history began with the reign of Nerva (96–97).[3] Most scholars have assumed that everything in Books I–XIII has irretrievably vanished, except for a few passing references that Ammianus makes to them in his later books. The earlier books were presumably lost because Ammianus' history, which was too long to fit into a single manuscript volume of convenient size, was copied into two volumes, of which only the second one became the ancestor of our manuscripts. Similarly, Procopius' long *History of the Wars* has reached us in separate manuscript volumes, one with Books I–IV and the other with Books V–VIII.[4] That the first volume of Ammianus' history included thirteen books while the second volume included eighteen is probably a sign that the average length of Books I–XIII was somewhat greater than that of those we have, because the binder who divided them should have tried to make the two volumes of comparable size to avoid producing a needlessly unwieldy tome. Ammianus' reason for ending Book XIII in the middle of the year 353 was evidently that it marked the death of the usurper Magnentius, an event not momentous enough to be a suitable dividing point for the whole work except for the binder's convenience.[5]

Even if Books I–XIII were on average slightly longer than the others, it would still be obvious that Ammianus recorded the events of his own lifetime at far greater length than he did earlier history. That disproportion has bothered many of those who have worked on Ammianus. The suggestion has therefore been made that Ammianus covered his chosen period in two different works with separately numbered books, like Tacitus in his *Annals* and *Histories*.[6] Yet Tacitus first wrote his *Histories* on the period from 69 to 96 and then his *Annals* on the earlier period from 14 to 69, so that he had little choice but to number the books of the *Annals* separately. The possibility that, like Tacitus, Ammianus wrote first on recent events and then on earlier events appears to be remote. In

---

ingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, 2007), pp. 314, 328 and *idem*, *The Middle Byzantine Historians* (Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, 2013), pp. 395–396.

2 On our mss. of Ammianus, see T. Barnes, *Ammianus Marcellinus and the Representation of Historical Reality* (Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 1998), pp. 201–208; G. Kelly, *Ammianus Marcellinus: The Allusive Historian* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2008), p. 1, n. 2.

3 Ammianus XXXI.16.9 (*a principatu Caesaris Nervae exorsus*).

4 Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 372–373; cf. Treadgold, *The Middle*, p. 477.

5 Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 60–61.

6 Most recently argued by H.T. Rowell, "The First Mention of Rome in Ammianus' Extant Books and the Nature of the 'History'," in *Mélanges d'archéologie, d'épigraphie et d'histoire offerts à Jérôme Carcopino* (Paris: Librairie Hachette, 1966): pp. 839–848.

his preface to Book XXVI, he states that he had originally concluded his history with 364 but has now continued it, without any hint that he had written a history of earlier times in between.[7] Since he then concludes Book XXXI by saying that he had begun with Nerva, he cannot have written on the earlier period after writing that book. Alternatively, the argument has been made that the books in our manuscripts have all been misnumbered by five, so that what we have are actually Books XIX–XXVI and eighteen books are lost.[8] This solution, however, requires several elaborate and not very plausible conjectures.[9] The scholarly consensus remains that we are missing thirteen books, which covered the second and third centuries only summarily.[10]

Ammianus' history is notorious for its exiguous influence on later Greek and Latin literature. It is attested only twice during the whole of Late Antiquity and the Middle Ages. The first attestation is by Ammianus' contemporary Libanius at Antioch, who cannot have read it because of his ignorance of Latin; the second is by the Latin grammarian Priscian at Constantinople, who may merely have glanced at a volume containing the books we now have, since he refers only to the beginning of Book XIV.[11] Besides these two attestations by name, scholars familiar with the twelfth-century Byzantine historian John Zonaras have known for some time that most of Zonaras' treatment of the years from 353 to 364 summarizes the contents of Ammianus' Books XIV–XXV.[12]

---

7 Ammianus XXVI.1.1–3.

8 Barnes, *Ammianus*, pp. 20–31.

9 See my objections in Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 60–61, n. 65. Note, however, that under Barnes' hypothesis each ms. volume would have had the same number of books: 18.

10 See Kelly, *Ammianus*, pp. 2–3; J. Matthews, *The Roman Empire of Ammianus* (Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 1989), pp. 27–30; R. Frakes, "Some Thoughts on the Length of the Lost Books of Ammianus," *Ancient World* 31 (2000): pp. 48–53; and D. Rohrbacher, "The Sources for the Lost Books of Ammianus Marcellinus," *Historia* 55 (2006): pp. 106–124, especially pp. 123–124. A. Cameron, *The Last Pagans of Rome* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2011), pp. 749–750, entertains the various ideas about the lost books (including his own tentative suggestion that Book XIV should be renumbered not XIX but XXIV) without finally choosing among them. In any case, my main concern here is not with the length or number of the lost books but with the material that can be recovered from them.

11 Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 51, n. 11; pp. 68–69, n. 84. On Libanius' ignorance of Latin, which was common among Greek intellectuals of the time, see Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, pp. 643–644.

12 While the parallels were first noticed in the late nineteenth century, they received renewed and expanded treatment from M. DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection: Zonaras, Ammianus Marcellinus, and John of Antioch on the Reigns of Constantius II and Julian," *Byzantion* 50 (1980): pp. 158–185. They are also discussed, with references to hypothetical sources that I think are misconceived, by B. Bleckmann, *Die Reichskrise des III. Jahrhunderts in der*

While Zonaras' summary is too brief to help much in correcting Ammianus' faulty text, with the possible exception of one lacuna that will be discussed below, the parallels between Zonaras and Ammianus show that knowledge of some of the information in Ammianus' history persisted in Byzantine historiography. Yet Ammianus' history is unlikely to have been preserved in Latin in Byzantium until the twelfth century, and even if it had been, Zonaras is very unlikely to have known enough Latin to read Ammianus in the original. Zonaras is therefore presumed to have taken his information from the full text of the *Chronological History* of John of Antioch, which survives today only in numerous fragments, most of them among the *Historical Excerpts* made for the tenth-century emperor Constantine VII Porphyrogenitus. In fact, several fragments of John's work show the same parallels with Ammianus as in Zonaras' history.

The question of how John of Antioch acquired his information from Ammianus is related to a longstanding dispute over the priority of the histories of John of Antioch and John Malalas.[13] These two histories are obviously related, because they share much of their contents and some of their wording, though Malalas' history ended with 565 and is written in a Greek that varies between *Koinē* and even less formal language, while John of Antioch's history ended with 610 and was written in Attic Greek up to about 518 and in *Koinē* thereafter. Moreover, Malalas, unlike John of Antioch, includes a large amount of independent material that is demonstrably spurious, including fanciful physical descriptions of historical figures and citations of about nine sources that are otherwise unknown and appear to be fictitious.[14] Until recently, the only posi-

spätantiken und byzantinischen Geschichtsschreibung: Untersuchungen zu den nachdionischen Quellen der Chronik des Johannes Zonaras (Munich: Tuduv, 1992), pp. 327–395 (cf. n. 105 below). On Zonaras, see also Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 388–399.

13 On this dispute, see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 235–256 (on Malalas), 311–329 (on John of Antioch); and *idem*, "The Byzantine World Histories of John Malalas and Eustathius of Epiphania," *International History Review* 29 (2007): pp. 709–745. Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, pp. 678–686 also discusses the controversy, but without mentioning my proposed solution, though he cites my *The Early Byzantine Historians* elsewhere. (On the other hand, when I sent my *The Middle Byzantine Historians* to the press, I was unaware of Cameron's useful remarks on John Zonaras in *The Last Pagans*, pp. 662–689, mistakenly thinking that the book would have nothing to say about my subject.)

14 See Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 246–251. Benjamin Garstad has now demonstrated that "Bottius," whom I had conjectured to be a source invented by Malalas, should be identified with a genuine source, probably better spelled "Bruttius" (B. Garstad, "Euhemerus and the Chronicle of John Malalas," *International History Review* 38 (2016): pp. 900–929), cf. Jerome, *Chronicle* 96e. On the other hand, I would now add Magnus of Carrhae to the sources invented by Malalas (see below, pp. 547–548 with nn. 72 and 73). Future discoveries may lead to some further modifications of the list of Malalas' invented sources.

tions taken by scholars were that Malalas had used John of Antioch, or that John of Antioch had used Malalas, or that the problem of who had copied whom was insoluble. The dispute has recently led to the publication of two drastically different editions of John of Antioch, one assuming the priority of Malalas and the other assuming the priority of John of Antioch.[15]

The trouble with supposing that John of Antioch used Malalas is that it compels us also to suppose that John of Antioch detected and excised all of Malalas' many fictions, turned Malalas' low style into formal Attic, and then wrote a continuation not in Attic but in *Koinē*. No one has plausibly explained why John of Antioch should have taken as a model a work he knew to be hopelessly inaccurate, or why he should have put Malalas' history into Attic but written in *Koinē* when he continued Malalas' work on his own. On the other hand, the assumption that Malalas used John of Antioch raises the problem that Malalas produced the first version of his history around 527 and the latest around 565, while John of Antioch's fragments extend to 610. The possible solution has been suggested that John of Antioch actually wrote his history in Attic around 518, that it was then used by Malalas, and that it was later continued to 610 in *Koinē* by an anonymous author whom the compilers of Constantine VII's *Excerpts* mistakenly thought was John of Antioch himself. The main problem with this theory is that it fails to account for a third work written around 518 that seems to have closely resembled those of both John Malalas and John of Antioch: the lost history of Eustathius of Epiphania.

We know that Eustathius of Epiphania's *Chronological Epitome* was copied in two volumes, the first covering the period from Adam to the fall of Troy and the second, divided into nine books, covering the period from Aeneas to the Persian capture of Amida in 503.[16] Eustathius' death occurred before 527, when he was cited by Malalas, who says that Eustathius died after writing a description of the fall of Amida "without having composed his account to the end."[17] Therefore Eustathius wrote some time after 503, and probably after the death of Anastasius I in 518, since historians usually ended their works before the reign of the current emperor, who in Eustathius' case was presum-

15 The edition that assumes the priority of Malalas is *Ioannis Antiocheni Fragmenta ex Historia Chronica*, ed. and trans. U. Roberto (Texte und Untersuchungen zur Geschichte der altchristlichen Literatur 154; Berlin: de Gruyter, 2005), while the edition that assumes the priority of John of Antioch is *Ioannis Antiocheni Fragmenta quae supersunt Omnia*, ed. and trans. S. Mariev (Corpus Fontium Historiae Byzantinae 47; Berlin: de Gruyter, 2008); cf. my review of both editions in *Speculum* 85 (2010): pp. 689–691. In the present article I cite only the much more complete edition of Roberto.

16 See Treadgold, *The Early*, p. 114.

17 Malalas XVI.9.

ably Justin I (518–527). Eustathius was also cited by the sixth-century historians Hesychius of Miletus and Evagrius of Epiphania. Evagrius praises Eustathius' elegant style, mentions "innumerable" sources that Eustathius summarized, and names some of them.[18] Several of these (e.g., the pagan historians Cassius Dio, Herodian, Dexippus, and Zosimus, and the ecclesiastical historians Eusebius, Socrates, Sozomen, and Theodoret) are also known to have been direct or indirect sources of Malalas and John of Antioch.[19]

Therefore, if we assume that John of Antioch wrote between 518 and 527, three very similar world histories that cited similar sources would have been composed during these nine years by Malalas, John of Antioch, and Eustathius of Epiphania. Moreover, at least the histories of John of Antioch and Malalas were presumably composed at Antioch, since Malalas states in the title of his history that he came from Antioch.[20] There are also grounds for thinking that Eustathius, who could scarcely have found all the books he needed in his native town of Epiphania, also wrote at Antioch, where his little-known history was later consulted by Evagrius.

The apparent solution to this conundrum is that both John of Antioch and Malalas copied the nearly finished history of Eustathius of Epiphania. John of Antioch copied it closely, probably almost verbatim in order to retain its elegant Attic style, then continued it to 610 in *Koinē*, since he apparently lacked the education to compose in good Attic himself. Malalas paraphrased Eustathius' history more freely into his own faltering attempt at *Koinē*, adding various fictions and errors, and then composed successive continuations up to 565. Consequently the author who knew Latin and copied Ammianus' Books XIV–XXV was Eustathius of Epiphania, not John of Antioch, who merely copied Eustathius.[21] Seemingly Zonaras took his summary of Ammianus' Books XIV–XXV from John

18 Evagrius I.19, III.26, III.37 (where he evidently misunderstood what Malalas says about the date of Eustathius' death), V.24 (for some of Eustathius' "innumerable" sources; Evagrius apparently names others at I.20). See also Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 114–120 (on Eustathius), 270–278 (on Hesychius), 299–308 (on Evagrius).

19 Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 312–314; 317, n. 22.

20 Treadgold, *The Early*, p. 241, n. 65.

21 While the poorly educated Malalas may have known a little Latin, the well-educated Eustathius was probably the direct source of the quotation and translation in Malalas XII.3 of Virgil, *Aeneid* IV.302–303. Eustathius was probably an official in the bureaucracy of the Diocese of the East at Antioch as early as 475 (Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 116–118, 326–327), when some knowledge of Latin would still have been common, especially for anyone who had to deal with legal matters, since the laws were in Latin; see A.H.M. Jones, *The Later Roman Empire, 284–602: A Social, Economic, and Administrative Survey* (Oxford: Blackwell, 1964), pp. 988–991.

of Antioch, whose work was still available in the middle Byzantine period, though at least some of Eustathius' original history also seems to have survived into the fourteenth century.[22]

Among a number of other Byzantine historians who evidently made direct or indirect use of John of Antioch's work, the largest amount of material appears to survive in two histories compiled by Theodore Scutariotes in the thirteenth century, his brief *Chronicle* and his much longer and more detailed *Chronological Synopsis*.[23] Scutariotes however seems to have drawn on John of Antioch's text only indirectly, by consulting a lost history by an unknown author that ended with the death of Alexius I Comnenus in 1118.[24] That this lost history was also Zonaras' source for material derived from John of Antioch seems unlikely, because the material from John of Antioch preserved by Zonaras is far more detailed and voluminous than that preserved by Scutariotes, a fact suggesting that Zonaras had John's full text but Scutariotes had only an abridged version of it in the lost history to 1118. In any case, for the purposes of the present

22 Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 70–73. John of Antioch frs. 145.1, 145.2, 145.3 (ed. Roberto) may actually be fragments of Eustathius' own work, since this part of cod. Athous 4932 = Iviron 812 has been preserved without an attribution; see Roberto's preface, pp. cxi–cxvii. For the sake of simplicity, here I ignore the possibility that later historians consulted Eustathius rather than John of Antioch, since the consequences would be practically identical for my purposes.

23 For Scutariotes' use of John of Antioch, see K. Zafeiris, *The Synopsis Chronike and its Place in the Byzantine Chronicle Tradition: Its Sources (Creation-1081 CE)* (diss. St. Andrews, 2007), http://hdl.handle.net/10023/457, especially pp. 226–228, though Zafeiris disputes, in my opinion not persuasively, the generally accepted attribution to Scutariotes of this anonymously transmitted *Synopsis*. My *Later Byzantine Historians* (in preparation) will include a discussion of Scutariotes and his two histories. See also R. Tocci, "Zu Genese und Kompositionsvorgang der Σύνοψις Χρονική des Theodoros Skutariotes," *Byzantinische Zeitschrift* 98 (2005): pp. 551–568 and the new edition of the *Chronicle*: *Theodori Scutariotae Chronica*, ed. R. Tocci (Corpus Fontium Historiae Byzantinae 66; Berlin: de Gruyter, 2015), pp. 66*–102* (on Scutariotes), 102*–115* (on the relationship between the *Chronicle* and the *Synopsis*).

24 See D. Sakel, "Another User of the Lost Source of Scutariotes," *Jahrbuch der Österreichischen Byzantinistik* 62 (2012): pp. 139–144, and *idem*, "Codex Patmiacus Graecus 132 and the Chronicle of Scutariotes," in *Atti del X Simposio su S. Giovanni Apostolo*, ed. L. Padovese (Roma: Istituto Francescano di Spiritualità: Pontificia Università Antoniano, 2005): pp. 313–323, though his description of the lost source on p. 315, n. 9, is not supported by the source he cites; E. Patzig, "Über einige Quellen des Zonaras," *Byzantinische Zeitschrift* 5 (1896): pp. 24–53, or by its continuation (not cited by Sakel); *idem*, "Über einige Quellen des Zonaras II," *Byzantinische Zeitschrift* 6 (1897): pp. 322–356. For a good recent discussion of Patzig's largely outdated articles and the whole problem, see T. Banchich and E. Lane, *The History of Zonaras from Alexander Severus to the Death of Theodosius the Great* (London: Routledge, 2009), pp. 8–10.

study the consequences would be very much the same whether Scutariotes or Zonaras used John of Antioch directly or indirectly.

II

At this point we should ask whether Zonaras, in summarizing John of Antioch's virtual transcription of Eustathius, may have preserved material not just from Ammianus' Books XIV–XXV but from Ammianus' preceding books that are now lost. For events from 353 to 364 Ammianus was evidently Eustathius' main source, although Eustathius seems to have supplemented Ammianus with material from the ultra-Arian ecclesiastical historian Philostorgius, other ecclesiastical historians, Eunapius of Sardis, and possibly a letter from Constantius II to Sapor II of Persia and two letters from Julian to Constantius.[25] Such letters could have been preserved in the government archives at Antioch, where Eustathius apparently served as an official.[26] However, Zonaras and John of Antioch also include other additions to Ammianus' account that cannot have come from government archives, such as Julian's epitaph and the Antiochenes' rebukes of Jovian after Julian's death.[27] The most economical hypothesis is thus that Eustathius made all these additions from Eunapius.

Zonaras appears not to include any material from Ammianus on the years from 364 to 378, for which Eustathius seemingly relied on Eunapius and other sources that were less detailed and accurate than Ammianus' Books XXVI–XXXI.[28] Yet why should the usually thorough and critical Eustathius have used an inferior source for the years from 364 to 378 in preference to Ammianus' history, which had been Eustathius' favorite source for the immediately preceding period? As has already been noted, we know from Ammianus' preface

25 The principal passages from the ecclesiastical historians are Zonaras XIII.11.14–29, XIII.13.5–44, XIII.14.2–9, though these also include some brief passages from Ammianus, and some brief passages from the ecclesiastical historians appear elsewhere. For the supposed letters of Constantius and Julian, see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 162–163. M. DiMaio, "Smoke in the Wind: Zonaras' Use of Philostorgius, Zosimus, John of Antioch, and John of Rhodes in his Narrative of the Neo-Flavian Emperors," *Byzantion* 58 (1988): pp. 230–255, especially p. 252, argued that John of Antioch included nothing from Eunapius that is not in Zosimus, but this seems unlikely; see the preface to Roberto's edition of John of Antioch, pp. cxli–cxliii.

26 See Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 116–118, 326–327.

27 John of Antioch fr. 273.2 (ed. Roberto) and Zonaras XIII.13.24.

28 See Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 242–258, especially nn. 131, 136, 137 on Zonaras' errors.

to Book XXVI that he wrote it and the following books only after an interval and as a supplement to his original history, which consisted of Books I–XXV.[29] He seems to have finished his original work around 390, and his supplement around 395.[30] Eustathius' ignorance of Ammianus' account of the period after 364 strongly indicates that Eustathius had a manuscript only of the original text of Ammianus, without the supplement consisting of Books XXVI–XXXI. This seems to be a decisive argument against the idea that Eustathius made use not of Ammianus but only of parts of Eunapius that Ammianus copied, because in that case Ammianus would have had no reason not to use Eunapius for events after 364 as well.[31] Perhaps Ammianus sent a manuscript of the initial version of his work to a friend or a library at Antioch, where it remained to be used by Eustathius over a hundred years later.

Consequently Eustathius is extremely unlikely to have had a manuscript of Ammianus' history that began with Book XIV, like all the manuscripts on which our text depends. Perhaps the twenty-five-book version was fitted into one large volume, or perhaps Eustathius had two volumes with the text divided differently. Even if Eustathius had only the second volume of a two-volume set, the division between his volumes would surely have been made after some book earlier than XIII, in order to make the two volumes roughly the same size. Eustathius is therefore very unlikely to have begun using Ammianus' history only with Book XIII. Thus we have good reason to look for possible fragments of Ammianus' lost books in the histories of Zonaras and Theodore Scutariotes. Several other Byzantine historians, including Theophanes Confessor, George the Monk, Symeon the Logothete, and Pseudo-Symeon (copied by George Cedrenus), seem also to have consulted John of Antioch, though their texts are usually too brief to be of much help.[32]

29 Ammianus XXVI.1.1–3.

30 Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 58–59, 73–75. A. Cameron, "Nicomachus Flavianus and the Date of Ammianus' Last Books," *Athenaeum* 100 (2012): pp. 337–358, has argued for a date ca. 390 for the supplement, taking a view of Ammianus' attitude toward contemporary emperors that differs from mine; see especially W. Treadgold, "Predicting the Accession of Theodosius I," *Mediterraneo Antico* 8 (2005): pp. 767–791.

31 Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, pp. 678–682, rightly believes that John of Antioch cannot have drawn directly on Ammianus because "it is impossible to believe that his Latin was good enough to read so long and difficult a Latin text" (p. 680); but, without considering the possibility that John copied Eustathius, Cameron improbably postulates that John copied Eunapius, who was in turn copied by Ammianus, who wrote after Eunapius' first edition appeared (pp. 668–678).

32 See Roberto's preface, pp. clx–clxii (Symeon and George the Monk), clxiii–clxvi (Pseudo-Symeon and Cedrenus), clxvii–clxviii (Zonaras); for Theophanes, see C. Mango and R. Scott, *The Chronicle of Theophanes: Byzantine and Near Eastern History, AD 284–813*

We should also examine our fragments of John of Antioch himself and even the text of John Malalas, who preserves much of the contents of Eustathius' history, though in a badly deformed state. Of course, since Eustathius interpolated his material from Ammianus' Books XIV–XXV with material from ecclesiastical historians, we should expect him to have done the same if he used the part of Ammianus' history before Book XIV. Which ecclesiastical historians Eustathius consulted is often unclear, since besides original works several compilations of ecclesiastical history might have been available to him.[33] Moreover, we have only an epitome and fragments of the ecclesiastical history of Philostorgius, which included a number of secular events. Usually, however, even without knowing exactly which texts Eustathius used, we can distinguish the material he took from ecclesiastical historians, both because most of their histories are partly or entirely preserved and because their interests and sympathies are recognizably different from those of Ammianus and other pagan historians.

The pagan histories directly or indirectly consulted by Eustathius included, to judge from our fragments of John of Antioch, the partly preserved history of Dio to 229, the history of Herodian from 180 to 238, the mostly lost history of Dexippus to 270, the Latin *Breviarium* of Eutropius, the mostly lost history of Eunapius, and the somewhat lacunose history of Zosimus, who largely abridged Eunapius.[34] Ammianus may himself in his lost books have made direct or indirect use of Dio, Herodian, and Dexippus. Ammianus also apparently consulted the hypothetical *Kaisergeschichte*, a lost Latin history used by Eutropius, Aurelius Victor, and others that seems to have extended to 358, perhaps with a continuation to 378.[35] Moreover, Zonaras surely knew

---

(Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997), p. lxxxi; and for Scutariotes, see n. 23 above. Further on these authors, see Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 38–77 (Theophanes), 114–119 (George the Monk), 203–217 (Symeon), 217–223 (Pseudo-Symeon), 339–341 (Cedrenus). Unfortunately, the relevant part of Pseudo-Symeon has not been published to date, though a text very much like it is available in an antiquated Bonn edition of George Cedrenus.

33 Among other possibilities, Eustathius may have used the ecclesiastical history of Gelasius of Caesarea, the *Chronicle* of Panodorus of Alexandria, or the *Tripartite History* of Theodore the Lector; see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 123 (Gelasius of Caesarea), 124–125 (Panodorus), 168–171 (Theodore the Lector); and *idem*, *The Middle*, pp. 52–62 (further on Panodorus). Cf. Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 228: "Zonaras ... depends on some parallel tradition that antedated and in places influenced Socrates, Sozomenus, Theodoret, and Theodore Lector."

34 See the preface to Roberto's edition, pp. cxxi–cxxxiv (Eutropius), cxxxvi (Dio), cxxxviii–cxxxix (Herodian), cxxxix–cxl (Dexippus), cxl–cxli (Zosimus), cxli–cxliii (Eunapius).

35 See most recently R.W. Burgess, "A Common Source for Jerome, Eutropius, Festus, Ammianus, and the Epitome de Caesaribus between 358 and 378, with Further Thoughts on the

Dio's history directly, and up to his concluding date of 229 evidently summarized Dio in preference to John of Antioch.[36] In other cases, we may have trouble telling whether a later historian knew Dio, Herodian, Dexippus, or the *Kaisergeschichte* directly or knew about them only from Eustathius, John of Antioch, or the lost books of Ammianus. Moreover, even if John of Antioch transmitted everything in Eustathius' text, the Constantinian *Excerpts* that supply us with most of our fragments of John, which are also sometimes transmitted through the tenth-century encyclopedia known as the *Suda*, have undergone considerable summarizing and reworking.[37] Another complication is that Zonaras sometimes combined several sources and added his own comments. Scutariotes, though he evidently includes some material from John of Antioch omitted by Zonaras, usually preserves a much more drastically abridged text than Zonaras does.

One observation may however be helpful for identifying material from Ammianus. The surviving books of Ammianus record all the ages of emperors at the times of their deaths, even including the Caesar Gallus and the usurper Procopius. Thus Ammianus tells us that Gallus died at 29, Constantius II died at "40 and a few months" according to our manuscripts (usually emended to 44 and a few months, which is correct), Julian died at 32, Jovian died at 33, Procopius died at 40 and 10 months, Valentinian I died at 55, and Valens died at "nearly" 50, apparently meaning 49.[38] Of the ages of these emperors, the only one recorded in our fragments of John of Antioch is 45 for Constantius II, which would be correct if counted inclusively but is not expressed in the same way as by Ammianus, even if Ammianus' text should be emended.[39] Yet Malalas and Scutariotes, both of whom evidently depended on John of Antioch, agree with

---

Date and Nature of the *Kaisergeschichte*," *Classical Philology* 100 (2005): pp. 166–192. See also Rohrbacher, "The Sources," pp. 108–112.

36 Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 393–395.

37 See Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 9: "The compilers of the *EH* [Constantine VII's *Excerpta Historica*] ..., as is evident from authors who survive independently, e.g. Thucydides, ... routinely adapted passages for incorporation into the various volumes of the *EH*. ... The paradoxical result is that texts of authors thought to have drawn directly upon works otherwise preserved in the *EH* and *Suda* may more accurately reflect their sources than do the actual 'fragments' of those sources." Further on the Constantinian *Excerpts*, see Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 153–165 and A. Németh, *Imperial Systematization of the Past: Emperor Constantine VII and His Historical Excerpts* (unpublished diss., Budapest: Central European University, 2010; http://www.etd.ceu.hu/2010/mphnea01.pdf).

38 Ammianus XIV.11.27 (Gallus), XXI.15.3 (Constantius II), XXV.3.23 (Julian), XXV.10.13 (Jovian), XXVI.9.11 (Procopius), XXX.6.6 (Valentinian I), XXXI.14.1 (Valens, *quinqagesimo anno contiguus*).

39 John of Antioch fr. 264 (ed. Roberto).

our manuscripts of Ammianus that Constantius died at 40.[40] Therefore the mistake seems to go back either to Ammianus himself or to a very early copyist, and our fragment of John of Antioch seems to have been altered either by a late copyist or by the Constantinian excerptor to make it agree with another, more accurate source.

The Byzantine historians who drew on Ammianus by way of Eustathius and John of Antioch sometimes recorded emperors' ages at their deaths and sometimes not. Zonaras says Julian died at 31, Jovian at 33, and Valentinian I at 84.[41] Zonaras' age of 31 for Julian is probably Eustathius' mistranslation of Ammianus' *anno aetatis altero et tricesimo*, which actually means 32; Zonaras' 33 for Jovian agrees with Ammianus; and Zonaras' 84 for Valentinian I confirms that Eustathius had to use another source for Valentinian's reign because his copy of Ammianus ended with the death of Jovian. Malalas says that Constantius II died at 40 (as we have seen), Julian at either 33 or 37 depending on the manuscript, Jovian at 60, Valentinian I at 55, and Valens at 49.[42] Apparently in our faulty manuscripts of Malalas the 31 (λα′) for Julian became corrupted to 33 (λγ′) or 37 (λζ′). Yet how Eustathius' 33 (λγ′) for Jovian became Malalas' 60 (ξ′) is hard to see. This may well be one of Malalas' many arbitrary fabrications, like his report that Nero, who actually committed suicide at 30, was murdered at age 69, which cannot be a copyist's error because Malalas says Nero had "completely gray hair."[43] Since Malalas' age of 49 for Valens is right, though Ammianus expresses it differently, here Malalas seems to have copied Eustathius, whose source (perhaps Eunapius) was right about Valens' age. (Malalas' accurate age of 55 for Valentinian may be a later copyist's correction). Finally Theodore Scutariotes has ages of 40 for Constantius II (as we have seen), 31 for Julian, 60 for Jovian, and 84 for Valentinian I.[44] This time Scutariotes seemingly consulted both Malalas and John of Antioch, and for some reason took the third age from Malalas and the other ages from John.

The period for which Ammianus' text is preserved corresponds to the hypothetical continuation of the Latin *Kaisergeschichte* from 358 to 378. While Ammianus apparently said that Constantius II died at 40 and a few months, Eutropius and Pseudo-Aurelius (author of the *Epitome de Caesaribus*) agree that Constantius died at 44, while Jerome says 45, which is probably either

40 Malalas XIII.17.95 and Scutariotes, p. 56.20.

41 Zonaras XIII.13.34 (Julian), XIII.14.24 (Jovian), XIII.15.20 (Valentinian I).

42 Malalas XIII.17 (Constantius II), XIII.24 (Julian; see Thurn's apparatus), XIII.27 (Jovian), XIII.32 (Valentinian I), XIII.35 (Valens).

43 Cf. Malalas X.30 (Nero ὁλοπόλιος), X.40 (his murder) with Treadgold, *The Early*, p. 249.

44 Scutariotes, pp. 56 (Constantius II), 57 (Julian and Jovian), 60 (Valentinian I).

inclusive reckoning or a copyist's error.[45] Ammianus, Eutropius, and Jerome agree that Julian died at the age of 32 and that Jovian died at the age of 33 (34 in some manuscripts of Jerome, again probably either inclusive reckoning or a copyist's error), while Pseudo-Aurelius' age of "nearly 40" for Jovian presumably comes from another source.[46] Ammianus and Pseudo-Aurelius agree that Valentinian I died at age 55.[47] These are all the ages we have to compare with Ammianus in the other Latin histories. On the questionable assumption that Ammianus really wrote that Constantius died at 44, these scanty data are barely compatible with the assumption that all four historians took their emperors' ages from the continuation of the *Kaisergeschichte*, but that only Ammianus was careful to copy all of them. Yet since all these historians were writing about times not long past, they could also have found the emperors' correct ages in several different ways, and in any case generalizations about the continuation of the *Kaisergeschichte* may not apply to the *Kaisergeschichte* itself.

Most Byzantine historians seldom if ever record the ages at which emperors died. George Syncellus, Theophanes, George the Monk, Symeon the Logothete, Pseudo-Symeon, and others record the lengths of emperors' reigns, but not the emperors' ages at death. Even among Eustathius' surviving sources, Herodian, Zosimus, and the ecclesiastical historians fail to record such ages. John of Antioch, however, seems to have recorded nearly all of them, presumably influenced by Ammianus by way of Eustathius. Though we have no text of Eustathius, and only fragments of the text of John of Antioch, if we put together the information on the emperors' ages at their deaths in the four main texts that appear to depend on Eustathius—John of Antioch, Malalas, Zonaras, and Scutariotes—we have an almost complete list of emperors' ages at death up to Phocas in 610, when John's history ended.[48] Before 364 only a few Caesars and usurpers are omitted, including Gallus and Procopius, whose ages Eustathius may not have bothered to copy from Ammianus. After 364 the only ages omitted are of ephemeral Western emperors, though the ages of Gratian, Valentinian II, and Valentinian III appear only in the fragments of John of Antioch.[49]

---

45 Cf. Ammianus XXI.15.3 with Eutropius X.15.2, Pseudo-Aurelius XLII.17, and Jerome, *Chronicle* 242[b]. Note that the continuation was not a source of Aurelius Victor, who concluded his history with 360.

46 Cf. Ammianus XXV.3.23 and XXV.10.13 with Eutropius X.16.2 and X.18.2, Jerome, *Chronicle* 243[b] and 243–244[e], and Pseudo-Aurelius XLIV.4.

47 Cf. Ammianus XXX.6.6 with Pseudo-Aurelius XLV.8.

48 Scutariotes, pp. 101.5 (Justinian I), 104.17 (Justin II), 105.2–3 (Tiberius II), 106.31 (Maurice), 107.26 (Phocas), 110.4 (Heraclius, perhaps taken from the continuation of John of Antioch; cf. Nicephorus, *Concise History* 27, and see Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 3–5).

49 John of Antioch, frs. 279 (Gratian), 280 (Valentinian II), 293.1 (Valentinian III). The age

Since John of Antioch evidently took the trouble to investigate emperors' ages at their deaths after Eustathius' history ended, presumably John also copied the ages given by Eustathius, who in turn had copied the ages given by Ammianus and investigated those after Ammianus' history ended. Even if some of these recorded ages are wrong or dubious, they remain indicators of an historiographical tradition followed by Ammianus, Eustathius, and John of Antioch.

Did the *Kaisergeschichte* belong to that tradition, so that it could have been Ammianus' source for the emperors' ages in his lost books? After 229, when Dio's history ends, Eutropius and Aurelius Victor never report an emperor's age at his death until that of Constantine I in 337. For these years Pseudo-Aurelius reports eight such ages, but remarkably, six of them disagree with the ages recorded by Malalas, Zonaras, and Scutariotes.[50] This is practically conclusive proof that Pseudo-Aurelius' ages depend on different sources from those of the Byzantine historians. Moreover, Eutropius and Victor, evidently relying on the *Kaisergeschichte*, both believe that Gordian II and Gordian III were the same emperor; but Scutariotes assigns them different ages, 50 and 28 respectively, showing that his source distinguished them from each other.[51] As for Constantine I, he died at 66 according to Eutropius and Jerome, at 62 according to Victor, and at 63 according to Pseudo-Aurelius.[52] Eustathius appears to have recorded Constantine's age, probably correctly, at 65 years and 3 months, since Malalas records it at 60 years and 3 months and Zonaras, Scutariotes, Theophanes, Symeon the Logothete, and Cedrenus all record it at 65 years.[53] In any case, the *Kaisergeschichte* was not the source of these ages in Ammianus, Eustathius, or any of the texts dependent on them.

---

for Honorius appears at Malalas XIII.49 (where μβ' seems to be an error for μ'), Zonaras XIII.21.17, and Scutariotes, p. 69.5.

50 Pseudo-Aurelius says Severus Alexander died at 25 (Scutariotes says 39), Gordian III at 18 (Scutariotes says 28), Decius at 50 (Malalas and Scutariotes say 60), Trebonianus Gallus at "around 46" (Malalas says 60), Aemilianus at 47 (Malalas agrees and Zonaras and Scutariotes say 40, probably to be emended to 47), Gallienus at 50 (Malalas and Scutariotes agree), Diocletian at 68 (Malalas says 72), and Licinius at "nearly 59" (Malalas says 46).

51 Cf. Eutropius IX.2 and Aurelius Victor 27 with Scutariotes, pp. 36.19 and 37.4.

52 Eutropius X.8.2, Jerome, *Chronicle* 234[b], Aurelius Victor 41.16, and Pseudo-Aurelius XLI.15.

53 Cf. Malalas XIII.14, Zonaras XIII.4.27, Scutariotes, p. 43.10–11, Theophanes A.M. 5828, p. 33.22–23, Symeon 88.1, and Cedrenus, p. 520.14. See T. Barnes, *The New Empire of Diocletian and Constantine* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1982), p. 42: "It may be concluded ... that Constantine was born on 27 February in either 272 or 273." Yet 273 seems preferable, especially because then Eutropius' and Jerome's 66 can be explained by their use of inclusive reckoning.

Not only was Eustathius' source for emperors' ages at their death plainly not the *Kaisergeschichte*, but that the *Kaisergeschichte* included any such ages seems unlikely in view of the disagreements among Eutropius, Victor, Pseudo-Aurelius, and Jerome. Evidently Eustathius, John of Antioch, Malalas, Zonaras, and Scutariotes drew indirectly on a list of the emperors' ages at their deaths, which Eustathius and John of Antioch continued after the version of Ammianus' history used by Eustathius ended with 364. The original list of ages, presumably compiled over a long period by a succession of writers and quite possibly including some inaccurate guesswork, was definitely not incorporated into the *Kaisergeschichte*. It probably formed part of a brief chronicle that included the lengths of the emperors' reigns, which most historians, including Ammianus, regularly record. For convenience, we may call this work the obituary chronicle.[54] If Ammianus used such an obituary chronicle for his lost books, as seems very likely, he must have combined it himself with the *Kaisergeschichte* and with whatever other sources he consulted.

III

We should now examine how Eustathius, as represented by Zonaras, John of Antioch, Malalas, Scutariotes, and other Byzantine authors, summarized parts of our surviving text of Ammianus. When we examine Zonaras' account of the years from 353 to 364, which includes the parallels to Ammianus, we find that most of it depends on Ammianus' Books XIV–XXV, but by no means all of it.[55] On the other hand, one brief passage in the preceding section of Zonaras' history evidently derives from Ammianus' Book XV. In describing the division of the empire among Constantine's sons in 337, Zonaras mentions that the Cottian Alps, which made up part of the share of Constantine II, were named for their former king Cottius, a fact that Ammianus mentions in a digression on Gaul when Julian was sent there in 355.[56] We shall soon see that Zonaras rearranged his source material in other places as well.

54 Even though this obituary chronicle probably included lengths of reigns as well as ages at death, the recorded lengths of reigns are a poor means of identifying a text, since most of them are correct (or slightly miscopied) and could therefore have come from any of a variety of sources.

55 For more detailed discussions of these parallels between Zonaras and Ammianus, with which I usually agree, see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection"; *idem*, "Smoke," pp. 230–255; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 216–241.

56 Cf. Zonaras XIII.5.3 with Ammianus XV.10.2.

As soon as our manuscripts of Ammianus' history commence with Book XIV, we find parallels to Ammianus in Zonaras' history. First Zonaras includes a summary of Ammianus' account of the oppressive rule of the Caesar Gallus at Antioch and his execution by Constantius in 353, though Zonaras omits parts of Ammianus' Book XIV on other subjects and evidently makes a few additions from Philostorgius.[57] Then Zonaras gives a summary of Ammianus' account in Book XV of the revolt of Silvanus in Gaul and its suppression in 355, omitting other parts of Book XV, skipping ahead to Book XVII for Ammianus' account of negotiations between Constantius and the Persians in 358, and making minor additions from either Eunapius or the government archives at Antioch.[58] Next Zonaras' summary returns to Ammianus' Book XV for Constantius' appointment of Julian as Caesar in 355 and Julian's successful wars in Gaul in Ammianus' Books XV–XVIII.[59]

Next Zonaras includes an item not in our text of Ammianus, that Julian's mother dreamed she would give birth to Achilles, along with an item to which Ammianus alludes in another context, that as a child Julian was entrusted to Bishop Eusebius of Nicomedia to learn the Scriptures.[60] The reference to Achilles indicates a pagan source favorable to Julian; since our text of Zonaras shows other rearrangements of Ammianus' material and Ammianus took dreams quite seriously, this source may well be a lost book of Ammianus that covered Julian's earlier life.[61] Next Zonaras has a summary of Ammianus' account in Book XX of Julian's proclamation as Augustus in 360 and his exchange of letters with Constantius, again with additions from either

57 Cf. Zonaras XIII.9.9–20 with Ammianus XIV.1, 7, 11 and Philostorgius III.28, 28a; IV.1, 1a; and see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 170–171 (though since John of Rhodes used the full text of Philostorgius, there is no need to propose him as a source along with Philostorgius); *idem*, "Smoke," pp. 231–235 and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 217–219 (though on p. 219 for "only Zonaras gives his age" read "only Ammianus gives his age").

58 Cf. Zonaras XIII.9.20–31 with Ammianus XV.5 and XVII.5 (plus Zonaras' short references to the Persian attacks in Ammianus XVIII and XIX); and see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 162–163, 165–166, 170; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 219–220.

59 Cf. Zonaras XIII.10.1–10 with Ammianus XV.8, XVI.1–4, 11–12, XVII.1, XVIII.2; and see DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 249–251; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 221.

60 Cf. Zonaras XIII.10.2–4 with Ammianus XXII.9.4 (not mentioning the Scriptures); see also DiMaio, "Smoke," p. 249, and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 220–221, who think that Zonaras' statement that Julian's parents entrusted his education to Eusebius is wrong, since both parents died before Julian was five; while this could be an incorrect inference by Eustathius from the fact that Eusebius did educate Julian, Julian's parents could also have made their intentions for his education known while he was still an infant.

61 For important dreams that foretold the future, see Ammianus XXI.1.6, XXI.1.12, XXI.2.2, XXI.14.1, XXV.2.3–4, XXV.10.16–17, XXX.5.18.

Eunapius or the state archives.[62] Zonaras continues with a summary of Ammianus' account of the abortive conflict between Julian and Constantius, a translation of a poem from Ammianus predicting Constantius' death, and Ammianus' obituary of Constantius in Book XXI, plus a section from ecclesiastical historiography on Constantius' Arianism.[63]

Zonaras' treatment of Julian's reign begins with a summary of parts of Ammianus' Books XXII and XXIII, returning briefly to Book XVIII for an anecdote that showed Julian's justice and incorporating additions from ecclesiastical historiography.[64] Next Zonaras gives an account of Julian's Persian campaign mostly summarized from Ammianus' Books XXIII through XXV, with additions from ecclesiastical historiography; exactly how much Zonaras' version depends on Ammianus is uncertain, because of a lacuna of unknown length at a crucial point in our text of Book XXIV.[65] This lacuna seems to correspond to Zonaras' report that two Persians claiming to be deserters treacherously persuaded Julian to burn his fleet, a story found elsewhere and apparently known to Ammianus as well.[66] Zonaras' account seems to combine at least two sources, since he mentions that the sources disagreed, reckons at 700 "triremes" and 400 transports the fleet that Ammianus' Book XXIII puts at 1000 transports, 50 warships, and 50 bridge-builders, and attributes to "the Gauls" a victory over the Persians during Julian's retreat, a detail omitted by Ammianus.[67] Here one source of Zonaras' source Eustathius was probably Philostorgius, who mentioned an elderly deserter from the Persian army who deliberately deceived Julian and ruined his expedition.[68] Yet given Eustathius' frequent

62 Cf. Zonaras XIII.10.11–22 with Ammianus XX.4, 8–9; and see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 163–166; *idem*, "Smoke," pp. 250–251; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 221–222.

63 Cf. Zonaras XIII.11 with Ammianus XXI.1–2, 5, 15–16; and see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 169, 172–173; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 222–227.

64 Cf. Zonaras XIII.12 with Ammianus XVIII.1, XXII.2–5, 9–12, 14, XXIII.1; and see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 166–168; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 227–233.

65 Cf. Zonaras XIII.13 with Ammianus XXIII.2, XXIV.6–8 (note the lacuna in XXIV.7.2), XXV.1–4, 9.12–13, 10.5; and see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," p. 169, n. 41; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 233–237.

66 See especially M. DiMaio, *"Infaustis Ductoribus Praeviis*: The Antiochene Connection, Part II," *Byzantion* 51 (1981): pp. 502–510.

67 Zonaras XIII.13.8 (the ships; cf. Ammianus XXIII.3.9), 13.10 (differences among sources), 13.11–12 (the Gauls; cf. Ammianus XXV.18–19). Note that Zonaras and Ammianus agree that the total number of ships was 1100. Both versions of Malalas XIII.21 give the number of ships as 1250, perhaps simply because of Malalas' tampering with his sources.

68 Philostorgius VII.15, 15a. To judge from Zosimus III.26.2–3, Eunapius said nothing about Persian deserters in connection with Julian's burning of the ships.

use of Ammianus and Ammianus' extensive coverage of Julian's campaign, the obvious candidate to be Eustathius' main source is Ammianus, whose lacuna can thus be filled in large part from Zonaras and a parallel passage in Malalas.[69] Finally, Zonaras' account of the short reign of Jovian shows parallels to Ammianus' Book XXV mixed with further material from ecclesiastical historiography.[70]

Malalas cites as sources for his account of Julian's Persian expedition "the most learned chronographer Magnus of Carrhae, who accompanied the emperor Julian," and "the chronographer Eutychianus the Cappadocian, a soldier and vicarius of his own regiment of the Primoarmeniaci, who was himself present in the war."[71] Malalas is our sole source for both of these "chronographers" and for the extremely suspicious regiment of the "Primoarmeniaci." Elizabeth Jeffreys has described Malalas' citation of Eutychianus as "a reference of exceedingly dubious quality," and I have identified as invented sources both "Eutychianus, meaning 'the Eutychian' (extreme Monophysite)," and the similar "Nestorianus, meaning 'the Nestorian,'" observing that they "look almost like jokes."[72] Yet most scholars have accepted the existence of Magnus of Carrhae, who has recently been described as a source independent of Ammianus and Eunapius because at one point Magnus seems to agree with Ammianus and at another with Eunapius.[73] A much more likely explanation is that Malalas simply attached the invented name of "Magnus of Carrhae" to a summary of the account that Eustathius compiled from Ammianus and Eunapius. Malalas

69 The parts apparently corresponding to the lacuna after Ammianus XXIV.7.2 are Zonaras XIII.13.4–7, 9 (omitting XIII.13.8, which differs slightly from Ammianus on the enumeration of the ships). The added details in Malalas XIII.22 (that the two false deserters were nobles who had their noses slit to make their story more plausible, and that Julian spared their lives even after they confessed) also seem likely to come from Ammianus, since they cannot belong to the alternative version about a single deserter. Matthews, *The Roman Empire*, p. 503, n. 65, declares himself "reluctant to accept DiMaio's view," without giving a reason.

70 Cf. Zonaras XIII.14 with Ammianus XXV.5–10; and see Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 237–242.

71 Malalas XIII.21 (Magnus) and XIII.23 (Magnus again and Eutychianus).

72 Jeffreys, "Malalas' Sources," in E. Jeffreys et al., *Studies in John Malalas* (Sydney: University of Sydney, 1990), p. 81 and W. Treadgold, *Early*, p. 251. Cf. *Prosopography of the Later Roman Empire* I (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1971), Eutychianus 3.

73 B. Bleckmann, "Magnus von Karrhai: Zur Bedeutung der Malalas-Chronik für die Rekonstruktion der Zeitgeschichte Julians," in L. Carrara et al., *Die Weltchronik des Johannes Malalas: Quellenfragen* (Stuttgart: Franz Steiner Verlag, 2017), p. 125. I too accepted the existence of Magnus of Carrhae despite some reservations (Treadgold, *Early*, p. 77 n. 132) until I considered the implications of Bleckmann's careful analysis.

probably borrowed the name Magnus from a Magnus who distinguished himself for bravery on this expedition according to Ammianus, Zosimus/Eunapius, and a fragment in the Suda presumably taken from John of Antioch/Eustathius. As for Carrhae, Malalas first mentions Magnus of Carrhae just before saying that Julian had passed by Carrhae, a fact also noted by Ammianus and Zosimus/Eunapius and presumably Eustathius.[74] In all probability not only "Eutychianus the Cappadocian" but also "Magnus of Carrhae" are among the fabricated authors that Malalas added to his chronicle to give the false impression that he had consulted many sources when he merely summarized Eustathius.

Opinions may differ about precisely how much Zonaras' account depends on Ammianus for the period from 353 to 364, because Zonaras' history is compressed and in Greek while Ammianus' history is expansive and in Latin, Zonaras adapted John of Antioch who copied Eustathius who in turn summarized Ammianus, and we lack full texts of Eunapius and Philostorgius to compare with Zonaras. Yet Ammianus covered this period in twelve books, Eunapius in about four, and Philostorgius, whose main concern was ecclesiastical history, in three and a half.[75] The surviving books of Ammianus are about seven times as long as the corresponding part of Zosimus' history. While we cannot be sure exactly how long Eunapius' and Philostorgius' books were, Ammianus must have treated the secular events of these years in considerably greater detail than either Eunapius or Philostorgius, or than any other history available to Eustathius.

As a participant in Julian's expeditions, Ammianus also wrote with more authority than younger armchair historians like Philostorgius or Eunapius (even though Eunapius had information from Julian's physician Oribasius). Perhaps more important to an orthodox Christian like Eustathius, Ammianus' paganism was less obtrusive than Eunapius' and Zosimus' paganism or Philostorgius' Eunomian Arianism.[76] One assessment of Zonaras' sources has concluded that Zonaras' text depends on Philostorgius mostly as a supplementary source and on Eunapius only as summarized by Zosimus.[77] Moreover, several

74 On Magnus, see Ammianus XXIV.4.23–24, Zosimus III.22.4, and *Suda* A 2094 (presumably from John of Antioch, though not included in Roberto's edition). For Julian's passing Carrhae, see Malalas XIII.21, Ammianus XXIII.3.1, and Zosimus III.13. Cf. *Prosopography*, Magnus 2 and 3.

75 For the book divisions of Eunapius and Philostorgius, see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 83–88, 128–132.

76 See Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 51–78 (Ammianus), 81–89 (Eunapius), 114–120 (Eustathius), 126–134 (Philostorgius).

77 DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 230–255, especially p. 252.

misunderstandings of Ammianus' Latin confirm that Eustathius used Ammianus.[78] Our surviving fragments of John of Antioch, though scanty and abbreviated, are compatible with this reconstruction.[79] The conclusion is therefore hard to escape that Ammianus was Eustathius' main and preferred source for secular history from 353 to 364.

IV

If Zonaras' narrative from 353 to 364 is largely derived from the preserved books of Ammianus, we should also examine the preceding section of Zonaras' narrative, running from the death of Constantine I in 337 to 353, for signs that it may depend on the lost books of Ammianus. To begin with, it has been rightly observed that in this period, for which John of Antioch was "almost certainly" Zonaras' "direct source," "Zonaras's account of the sole reign of Constantius II (350–361), thirty pages in Büttner-Wobst's edition, is completely out of proportion to his treatment of preceding and following reigns. No fewer than eighteen of these pages are devoted to the usurpation of Magnentius (350–353), by far the fullest account that has come down to us. Furthermore, no more than two of these thirty pages are concerned with church affairs, an astonishing proportion for any Byzantine historical epitome. More remarkable still, most of these thirty pages are pure narrative, covering the events of a very brief period in considerable detail, again highly unusual in such a work."[80] Since this exceptional amplitude and interest in secular history on the part of Zonaras cover the periods both before and after Ammianus' surviving books begin with 353, we might plausibly guess that the coverage of both periods mainly depends on the same source, namely Ammianus.

For the years beginning with 337 we have already found some dependence on a surviving book of Ammianus, Book XV, which parallels Zonaras' explanation of the name of the Cottian Alps, part of the inheritance of Constantine II in 337.[81] We have also found a passage in a later part of Zonaras, describing the

78 See DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 166–169; and, for Julian's age at his death (mentioned above on p. 541 and n. 42), cf. Zonaras XIII.13.34 (τριάκοντα πρὸς ἑνὶ βιώσας = 31) with Ammianus XXV.3.23 (*anno aetatis altero et tricensimo* = 32).

79 See John of Antioch, frs. 261–273.2 (ed. Roberto); but see also the comments of Banchich and Lane quoted in n. 37 above and DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," p. 170: "Zonaras seems to have included material in his narrative which is not preserved in the extant text of John [of Antioch]."

80 Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, p. 688.

81 Cf. Zonaras XIII.5.3 with Ammianus XV.10.2.

dream of Julian's mother that she would bear an Achilles, that may well come from the part of Ammianus' history that described how Julian survived his father's lynching in 337 and was educated by Eusebius of Nicomedia.[82] Zonaras begins his narrative by noting that different sources disagreed as to whether the tripartite division of the empire after 337 was made by Constantine I himself or by his sons after his death, showing that Zonaras failed to realize that Constantine had made a quadripartite division including his nephew Dalmatius that his sons converted into a tripartite division after Dalmatius was killed. Evidently Eustathius again had at least two sources, one of them probably Philostorgius, who appears not to have mentioned Constantine's four-part division, as the earlier and more detailed account of Ammianus must have done and Zosimus/Eunapius and Eutropius did.[83] The other source seems unlikely to have been Eutropius, who is not detailed enough, and was probably Ammianus, perhaps along with Zosimus/Eunapius.

Zonaras goes on to describe Constantine II's defeat by Constans and Constans' assassination by Magnentius, supplying the most detailed description we have of Constantine II's death.[84] While Philostorgius did mention these events, Ammianus must have said more about them, and seems most likely to have been Zonaras' indirect source. Then Zonaras describes Constantius' warfare with Sapor II of Persia, including an account of Persian politics and the escape of Sapor's imprisoned brother Hormisdas to the Roman Empire, which actually occurred before 337. While Eutropius omits this incident and Philostorgius seems not to have mentioned it either, Ammianus says in his Book XVI that he had recorded Hormisdas' escape in an earlier book, and Zosimus/Eunapius and a fragment of John of Antioch both include it. Yet Zosimus/Eunapius says that Hormisdas fled to Constantine I, while John of Antioch says Hormisdas fled to Licinius.[85] By process of elimination, Ammianus was almost certainly Eustathius' source for the flight of Hormisdas to Licinius, which may have appeared in a digression on relations with Persia early in Constantius' reign.

---

82 Zonaras XIII.10.2–4. Ammianus could also have mentioned this omen when recording Julian's birth in 332.

83 Cf. Zonaras XIII.5.1–4 with Philostorgius III.1, 1a, Zosimus II.39–40, and Eutropius X.9; and see DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 236–244; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 209–210.

84 Cf. Zonaras XIII.5.5–16 with Philostorgius III.1, 1a, 22, 22a–26a; and see DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 240–244; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 210–212.

85 Cf. Zonaras XIII.5.5–6, 5.17–34 with Ammianus XVI.10.16, Zosimus II.27, and John of Antioch fr. 266 (ed. Roberto); and see DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 239–240; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 210, 212–213. Note that the reference to Hormisdas in the *Suda* M 230, which says he fled to Constantine, should therefore come from Eunapius, not John of Antioch.

Although the objection has been raised that both Zonaras and John of Antioch say Sapor and Hormisdas were sons of the Persian king Narses, while Ammianus should have known they were Narses' grandsons, the most likely explanation is that the identification of the two as Narses' sons was a mistake in summarizing by Eustathius.[86]

Then Zonaras returns to Magnentius' rebellion and gives a detailed description of how it began, as Ammianus must also have done, to judge from his eight references to his earlier account of Constans and Magnentius.[87] Zonaras says that Magnentius was proclaimed emperor at "Augustulum" at a birthday celebration for Magnentius himself, while Zosimus names the place correctly as Augustodunum (Autun) and says that the birthday celebration was for a son of Magnentius' co-conspirator Marcellinus.[88] Evidently Eustathius, an Easterner unfamiliar with Augustodunum, miscopied its name, while his statement that the celebration was for Magnentius' own birthday may have been a mistake in summarizing. Yet the main source of Eustathius/John/Zonaras seems not to have been Zosimus, since, unlike Zosimus, Zonaras is hostile to Magnentius and gives a more detailed account of the murder of Constans, including an age at death that follows the practice of Ammianus.

Then, returning to the East, Zonaras gives a description of Sapor II's failed siege of Nisibis in 350 that appears to be independent of our other accounts.[89] The degree of detail in this description, including a statistic for the size of the besieging force and an historical note that Nisibis had once belonged to Tigranes II of Armenia and Mithridates VI of Pontus, points to Ammianus as the source. Next Zonaras gives his detailed description of Constantius' campaign against Magnentius and the rebel's first defeat. While this description shows a few similarities to the similarly detailed account of the same campaign by Zosimus, it repeatedly differs with Zosimus and Philostorgius.[90] Zonaras'

86 For the objection, see DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 184–185.

87 Cf. Zonaras XIII.6 with Ammianus XV.5.16, XV.6.4, XVI.6.2, XX.1.1, XXI.8.1, XXII.13.3, XXVII.8.4, XXVIII.3.8; and see DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 242–244; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 213.

88 Cf. Zonaras XIII.6.2 with Zosimus II.2–4.

89 Zonaras XIII.7.1–14; and see Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 213–214; and especially M. Dodgeon, S. Lieu, *The Roman Eastern Frontier and the Persian Wars, AD 226–363: A Documentary History* (London: Routledge, 1991), pp. 193–207. Philostorgius III.22, 22a–26a and Zosimus II.43.1 say nothing about this siege and barely mention the war.

90 Cf. Zonaras XIII.7.15–8.25 with Philostorgius III.22–25, 22a–26a and Zosimus II.43–54; and see DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 244–247 (listing three verbal similarities with Zosimus in n. 94 and a dubious one with Julian in n. 95); and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 214–217. The verbal parallels with Zosimus may well mean that here Eustathius supplemented

report of a dream in which Constantine I urged Constantius to avenge his brother Constans is paralleled only in a fragment in the Constantinian *Excerpts* from the sixth-century history of Peter the Patrician, whose source may well have been Eustathius copying Ammianus, since Ammianus considered dreams important.[91] Zonaras also supplies unique and credible statistics for the sizes and casualties of the armies of Constantius and Magnentius, another feature of Ammianus' surviving books.[92] Then Zonaras includes an account of a failed plot by Magnentius to have the Caesar Gallus assassinated at Antioch, which seems unlikely to depend on Ammianus because it looks like an independent account of a plot that Ammianus recorded differently.[93] Here Zonaras' actual source was probably Philostorgius.

Finally Zonaras describes how Magnentius lost another battle to Constantius, stabbed his own brother Desiderius, and killed himself, and then how Magnentius' other brother Decentius, whom he had named Caesar, hanged himself, and how Desiderius, who had survived his wounds, surrendered to Constantius.[94] This story has been doubted, because Zonaras is our only source for the name of Desiderius, which might be considered a variant of Decentius, well attested as Magnentius' Caesar.[95] Nonetheless, all our sources who mention Decentius agree with Zonaras that he was not killed or wounded by Magnentius but killed himself.[96] Philostorgius apparently said that Magnentius killed an (unnamed) brother before stabbing himself.[97] Socrates, followed by Sozomen, agrees with Zonaras that Magnentius had two brothers and that Decentius hanged himself, although, apparently copying Philostorgius,

---

Ammianus with Zosimus, whom Eustathius evidently used elsewhere (see Treadgold, *The Early*, p. 306, n. 69).

91 See *Excerpta Historica iussu imp. Constantini Porphyrogeniti confecta* I.2 (Berlin: Apud Weidmannos, 1903), p. 395. On Peter's history, see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 267–268. If my interpretation is right, Peter's source cannot have been John of Antioch, who wrote ca. 610. For Ammianus' opinion of dreams, see n. 61 above.

92 See Treadgold, *The Early*, p. 76.

93 See Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 216–217, comparing Zonaras XIII.8.25–31 (a plot by Magnentius betrayed by a clever old woman) with Ammianus XIV.7.4 (a plot by low-ranking soldiers betrayed by a contemptible woman). R. Frakes, "Ammianus and Zonaras on a Late Roman Assassination Plot," *Historia* 46 (1997): pp. 121–128, argues against any connection between these two passages, but seems to me to rely too much on Ammianus' following a strict chronological order.

94 Zonaras XIII.9.1–8; cf. DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 246–247; and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 71.

95 *Prosopography*, under Decentius 3 and "*!Desiderius!* 1"; and DiMaio, "Smoke," pp. 246–247.

96 See the eight sources cited by *Prosopography* under Decentius 3.

97 Philostorgius III.26.

Socrates and Sozomen also say that before stabbing himself Magnentius killed another (unnamed) brother whom he had made his Caesar.[98]

Note that the ecclesiastical historians disagree with Zonaras only by saying that the unnamed other brother was Magnentius' Caesar and was not just wounded but killed by Magnentius. Therefore Philostorgius cannot have been Zonaras' source, and since he was evidently wrong that the other brother was Magnentius' Caesar, Philostorgius may also have been wrong that this brother died of his wounds. That two brothers had names as similar as Decentius and Desiderius is not even slightly suspicious at a time when brothers were named Constantine, Constans, and Constantius, or Valentinian and Valens. The most likely explanation is that Zonaras' account is correct and its source was Ammianus' lost Book XIII. At this point Zonaras starts to follow Ammianus' account of Gallus' rule at Antioch at the beginning of Ammianus' first surviving book, Book XIV.

Malalas and Scutariotes both give such abbreviated accounts of the secular events from 337 to 353 that they include little that could come from Ammianus and cannot be found at greater length in Zonaras' work. Malalas does however add reports that Constantine II died at age 20 and Constans at age 27, though Zonaras says Constans died at 30.[99] Malalas' age for Constantine II should probably be emended from 20 to 24, which would then be correct, the error having been made either by Malalas or by a copyist of Malalas' history. Curiously, however, Malalas' age of 27 for Constans is supported by Pseudo-Aurelius, and Zonaras' age of 30 for Constans is supported by Eutropius and Jerome.[100] A possible explanation is that both Ammianus and Eustathius mentioned that reports of Constans' age at death varied between 27 and 30, while Malalas chose to report only the first age and Zonaras chose to report only the second.

Anyone who would maintain that Ammianus was not the source of the bulk of Zonaras' account of the years from 337 to 353 should suggest a more likely lost source who described these events in detail and was not Philostorgius or Zosimus/Eunapius. Moreover, anyone who maintains that Ammianus was not the main source of this part of Zonaras' history needs to explain why the compiler evidently used Ammianus' history for the period after 353 but not before, or why his copy of Ammianus' history, which ended well before our copies do, began exactly where our copies do. I doubt that any plausible alternative

98 Socrates II.32 and Sozomen IV.7.3.

99 Malalas XIII.15 (Constantine II), XIII.16 (Constans), and Zonaras XIII.6.12 (Constans).

100 Cf. Pseudo-Aurelius XLI.23, Eutropius X.9.4, and Jerome, *Chronicle* 237^{c}. See Barnes, *The New Empire*, pp. 44–45, 46.

explanations can be offered. We should also expect this part of Ammianus' history to have been reasonably accurate, since Ammianus was born around 330 and must have had access to good oral and written sources going as far back as 337.[101] Unfortunately, partly because Eustathius' Latin was imperfect and partly because both he and Zonaras were compiling world histories of which this period was only a small part, the summaries provided by Zonaras that can occasionally be supplemented from Malalas and Scutariotes are sometimes inaccurately transmitted, much shorter than Ammianus' original text, and mixed with information from other sources, especially Philostorgius.

If the hypothesis that Ammianus was the main source on which Zonaras depends for these years is accepted, we may be able to make a very rough calculation of the length of Ammianus' treatment of the years from 337 to 353. Zonaras' treatment of the years from 353 to 364 is about 5% as long as Books XIV–XXV of Ammianus, which cover the same period. Admittedly, this part of Zonaras includes a good deal of information not derived from Ammianus, most of it apparently from Philostorgius, and omits a good deal of information that is in Ammianus, especially the digressions and invented speeches that Zonaras says his friends had asked him to drop from his sources.[102] On the other hand, we can assume that Zonaras' treatment of the preceding period also included a good deal of information not in Ammianus, most of it apparently from Philostorgius, and omitted a good deal of information in Ammianus, especially digressions and speeches. One possible objection is that because Ammianus says in his preface to Book XV that from that point he intended to write more extensively, Eustathius and Zonaras might have chosen to include more of Ammianus' more concise account up to Book XIII than they did later.[103] However, several scholars have observed that our extant Book XIV is about as ample as the later books and that Ammianus' references to his lost books imply that he also gave quite ample treatment to the years beginning with 337.[104]

In any case, Zonaras' treatment of the period from 337 to 353 is a little less than three-quarters as long as his treatment of the period from 353 to 364, to which Ammianus devoted twelve books. If on average Zonaras drew approximately the same amount of material from each of Ammianus' books in both periods, Ammianus covered the period from 337 to 353 in about nine books,

101 On Ammianus' life, see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 52–59.

102 Zonaras, preface 1, pp. 4–7; cf. Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 33–34.

103 Ammianus XV.1.1.

104 See Rowell, "The First Mention," pp. 839–845; Matthews, *The Roman Empire*, pp. 18, 27–30; and Barnes, *Ammianus*, pp. 26–30.

leaving roughly four books for the period from 96 to 337. If Book V began with 337, from 337 to 353 Ammianus' treatment would have averaged rather less than two years per book, about twice his pace from 353 to 364, a little less than one year per book. This would also mean that Ammianus covered the years from 96 to 337, before the times that he and his informants could remember, on a dramatically different scale, averaging about sixty years per book. While this estimate may go too far in supposing that Ammianus covered the events of his youth at the same rate as those of his maturity, note that advancing the point of expansion by a book or two would make relatively little difference in the disproportion. If it was Book VII that began with 337, Ammianus would have covered the years from 337 to 353 at an average of somewhat more than two years per book, and the years from 96 to 337 at an average of about forty years per book.

V

We should now look for indications that Zonaras, following Eustathius, might have used Ammianus for the times of Diocletian and Constantine I, from 284 to 337.[105] Philostorgius did not cover this period, except for its very end, while Zosimus' account of Diocletian has been lost in a lacuna. Zonaras' brief description of Diocletian's accession is quite similar to that of Eutropius. Yet Zonaras includes several facts omitted by Eutropius: that Diocletian had been Duke of Moesia and Count of the Domestici before becoming emperor, that he told the army that the murderer of his predecessor Numerian was Aper, that Aper was "prefect of the army" (i.e., Praetorian Prefect), that Diocletian visited Rome to inaugurate his reign, and that Diocletian made Maximian his colleague either in his second year (correct) or in his fourth (incorrect, even if referring to Maximian's promotion to Augustus in Diocletian's third year).[106] Interestingly,

105 While most of the remainder of my discussion parallels that of Bleckmann, *Die Reichskrise*, I agree with Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, p. 627: "The solid and lasting contribution of Bleckmann's book was to demonstrate just how much good evidence for the late third and early fourth centuries survives in the twelfth-century history of the Byzantine monk Zonaras. At least one lost late antique source needs to be postulated to account for all this material. Unfortunately, Bleckmann was persuaded by Paschoud to identify this lost source as Flavian [Nicomachus Flavianus]." I see no reason to repeat or summarize the extensive and conclusive arguments against this identification presented by Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, pp. 617–690. As will appear, I identify the principal lost source as the lost books of Ammianus.

106 Cf. Zonaras XII.31, pp. 613.14–614.7, and Scutariotes, p. 40.27–28 (also putting the appoint-

Theophanes also includes the mistake that Diocletian made Maximian his colleague in his fourth year, and George Syncellus, whose chronicle Theophanes continued from 284, includes the facts that Aper was prefect of the army and had murdered Numerian and that Diocletian went to Rome in 284.[107] Aurelius Victor also says that Aper was Praetorian Prefect and Numerian's murderer, presumably because Victor used Eutropius' source.[108]

The agreement of Zonaras with Theophanes and George Syncellus should not be particularly surprising, since John of Antioch is known to have been a source of Theophanes, and Theophanes had received from George the materials that he used to continue George's chronicle, presumably including the history of John of Antioch.[109] John's source, Eustathius, must therefore either have combined Eutropius with another source, or consulted Eutropius' source, or consulted another source that used Eutropius' source. Since, as several scholars have noticed, Zonaras' parallels with Eutropius usually include more information than is to be found in the text of Eutropius, the conclusion that Eustathius repeatedly used another source to interpolate Eutropius seems much less likely than that Eustathius and Eutropius shared a source, if perhaps indirectly. According to all recent authorities, Eutropius' source (and Victor's) was the hypothetical *Kaisergeschichte*.

For this reason the suggestion has recently been made that John of Antioch (for whom we may substitute Eustathius) used a Greek translation of the *Kaisergeschichte*.[110] Yet Greek translations of Latin works were very rare in Antiquity, and since the *Kaisergeschichte* seems to have been lost even in Latin and in the West soon after the end of the fourth century, even the Latin text is extremely unlikely to have reached Eustathius in Antioch in the early sixth century.[111] Although Eustathius found Ammianus' history at Antioch, Ammianus was an Antiochene who must have had associates in the city to whom he

---

ment of Maximian in Diocletian's fourth year) with Eutropius VIII.19–20. See also Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 135–136.

107 Theophanes, A.M. 5780 (287/88), p. 6, and George Syncellus, A.M. 5776 (283/84), p. 472 (calling Aper first ἐξάρχου of the army and then ὕπαρχον, both obviously errors for Zonaras' ἔπαρχον; cf. *Prosopography*, Aper 2).

108 Aurelius Victor 38.6.

109 Theophanes, preface, pp. 3–4.

110 Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, pp. 665–668. Cameron includes an argument for the existence of such a translation based on one minor error shared by George Syncellus and the fourth-century historian Festus that could simply be a coincidence.

111 Cf. Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, p. 674: "The *KG* cannot have been significantly more detailed than its various derivatives and continuations, which in turn explains why it disappeared without trace."

could have sent his work, and even so Eustathius found only a copy of the first edition. A much simpler and likelier hypothesis than a Greek translation of the *Kaisergeschichte* is that Eustathius copied not Eutropius or the *Kaisergeschichte* but Ammianus, who is known to have used the *Kaisergeschichte* and, since he surely wrote at greater length than its other users including Eutropius, must have included most of what was in it. After all, if Eustathius used Ammianus' history for the period after 337, why should he not have used it for the earlier period, when sources were less abundant?

Because Ammianus seldom dates events by years, Eustathius may himself have muddled the chronology if he failed to distinguish Maximian's two promotions to Caesar and to Augustus and then tried to use Ammianus' account to date what he thought had been a single promotion.[112] Otherwise Zonaras' additional details appear significant and plausible, though his reports that Diocletian had been Duke of Moesia and visited Rome are unique and have been doubted, evidently because of Zonaras' late date.[113] Yet neither report is improbable in itself. Diocletian was evidently an experienced commander who had held important military posts, and for a new emperor to visit Rome to inaugurate his reign had long been customary, so much so that Diocletian's supposed decision not to do so has been considered a deliberate break with precedent.[114] If Diocletian did visit Rome, Ammianus would surely have mentioned it, since he was particularly interested in the city and provides a lengthy description of Constantius II's visit there in 357.[115]

Next Zonaras refers to Diocletian's and Maximian's persecuting Christians, perhaps relying as much on his memory as on Eustathius' summary of a derivative of Eusebius' *Ecclesiastical History*, since he puts the beginning of the persecution too early.[116] Then Zonaras summarizes the events of the First Tetrarchy, once more showing unmistakable parallels to Eutropius' history but adding more information.[117] Again Zonaras evidently followed Ammianus by way of Eustathius and John of Antioch. John and Zonaras share the error that the Quinquegentiani ("men of the five tribes"), a band of Moors who invaded Roman Africa, were "five men of Gentiani"—an obvious misinterpretation by

112 On Ammianus' dating, see Barnes, *Ammianus*, pp. 43–51.

113 For doubts, see *Prosopography*, Diocletianus 2; T. Barnes, *Constantine and Eusebius* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1981), p. 5 ("perhaps"); *idem*, *The New Empire*, p. 50; and S. Williams, *Diocletian and the Roman Recovery* (New York: Methuen, 1985), p. 241, n. 1.

114 Williams, *Diocletian*, p. 41.

115 For Constantius' visit to Rome, see Ammianus XVI.10.

116 Zonaras XII.31, pp. 614.8–15; see Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 136.

117 Cf. Zonaras XII.31, pp. 614.16–617.14, and Scutariotes, p. 41.1–12 with John of Antioch frs. 247, 248, 249 (ed. Roberto) and Eutropius IX.20–26.

Eustathius of a Latin source derived from the *Kaisergeschichte*, since both Eutropius and Victor mention the Quinquegentiani.[118] Ammianus, Eustathius' probable Latin source, presumably mentioned the Quinquegentiani as well. Zonaras himself seems to be responsible for misnaming Constantius I "Constans" and the usurper Carausius "Crassus," because John of Antioch uses the correct forms of both names, though Scutariotes, apparently following Zonaras, uses "Constans."

The events in this section that are noted by Zonaras but not by Eutropius are the revolt of the cities of Busiris and Coptus in Egypt, Constantius I's epithet of "Chlorus," a list of the first seven Sassanid kings of Persia, and the peace treaty made between Diocletian and Narses I of Persia. Again Zonaras' additional information appears to be accurate, with the likely exception of the epithet "Chlorus," which appears to be attested only in the early sixth century and may have been added by Eustathius.[119] The revolt of Busiris and Coptus is otherwise attested solely by Eusebius' *Chronicle* under the year 293 and in its translation by Jerome, and by Theophanes, who evidently relied on John of Antioch.[120] The list of the Persian kings is also paralleled in George Syncellus' chronicle.[121] Thus almost all of Zonaras' secular history of the First Tetrarchy can be plausibly attributed to Ammianus.

There follows a short description of Diocletian's persecution of Christians, taken by Eustathius from a text derived from Eusebius, perhaps the lost fifth-century chronicle of Panodorus of Alexandria.[122] Next Zonaras records the

118 Cf. Zonaras XII.31, p. 615.12 (πέντε τινῶν Γεντιανῶν) with John of Antioch fr. 247.12–13 (ε' ἀνδρῶν Γεντιανῶν). Eutropius IX.22.1, 23 refers to the Quinquegentiani and Aurelius Victor 39.22 to the *nationes Quinquegentanae*, a clearer formulation; Eustathius' source, probably Ammianus, must have been less clear, like Eutropius.

119 See *Prosopography*, Constantius 12. The epithet appears at Malalas XII.48, but not in John of Antioch fr. 252 (ed. Roberto), where Constantius is given the Latin epithet "Pauper" (though "Chlorus" could of course have appeared in the full text of John).

120 Jerome, *Chronicle* 226ª; note that this entry is also found in the Armenian translation, and therefore goes back to Eusebius. Cf. Theophanes A.M. 5782 (289/90), p. 6.23–25 (where Busiris is misspelled Ὀβούσιριν, evidently because Theophanes misunderstood the article in ὁ Βούσιρις as part of the name).

121 Cf. Zonaras XII.31, p. 616.4–10 with George Syncellus A.M. 5715 (222/23), p. 441 (at 441.9, for ἄλλος δ' read ἄλλως δ' (μῆνας)). Note that this list is accurate if Vararaces (Οὐαραράκης), mentioned by both Zonaras and George, is understood to be Vararanes II (*Prosopography*, Vararanes II). Note also that this list differs slightly from that of Agathias IV.24.1–25.1, who uses "Hormisdates" for "Hormisdas" and "Vararanes" (correctly) for "Vararaces," indicating that George depended not on Agathias but on the full text of John of Antioch for the first part of his list; the second part includes kings after Agathias' time.

122 Cf. Zonaras XII.32, pp. 617.15–618.3 with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 140. On Panodorus, see n. 33 above.

retirements and triumphal celebrations of Diocletian and Maximian, including a digression on the Greek derivation of the word "triumph." Parallels with fragments of John of Antioch again indicate that John was Zonaras' source. Once more Zonaras shows clear parallels with Eutropius, but the digression on the triumph is not in Eutropius, and as a Greek with a fondness for digressions Ammianus seems to be its most likely source.[123] Another passage follows in which Eustathius apparently cited Eusebius, but is more likely to have depended on Panodorus.[124] Proceeding to the dissolution of the second Tetrarchy, Zonaras has another passage with parallels to Eutropius but several additions: that Maximian told the Roman Senate of his son Maxentius' unfitness to rule but quickly recanted, that Maximian hanged himself, and that Constans (i.e., Constantius I) preferred Constantine to his sons by his second marriage, whom Zonaras names but Eutropius does not.[125] As before, the most likely source of the passages with incomplete parallels to Eutropius is Ammianus, who apparently transmitted more of the information in the *Kaisergeschichte* than Eutropius did.

Then, with Constantine's reign, the character of Zonaras' text shows a marked change, which (to judge from our fragments of John of Antioch) occurred in Eustathius' text as well. Zonaras' account of Constantine begins with a vision of an angel that told Constantius I to name Constantine his heir, a series of legendary labors assigned to Constantine by the Eastern emperor Galerius, and a short description of the conflict between the Eastern emperors Maximinus and Licinius that confuses Maximinus with Galerius.[126] This section obviously comes from a pro-Christian and relatively late source, certainly not the pagan historians Ammianus, Eutropius, Eunapius, or Zosimus, but probably the same lost biography of Constantine that appears to lie behind most of Zonaras' account of that emperor.[127] It seems to be unrelated to a section that

123 Cf. Zonaras XII.32, pp. 618.4–619.19, and John of Antioch frs. 250, 251.1, 251.2 (ed. Roberto) with Eutropius IX.27, X.1 and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 140–142.

124 Cf. Zonaras XII.32, pp. 619.19–621.23, and John of Antioch frs. 250.1, 251.2 (ed. Roberto) with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 142–145.

125 Cf. Zonaras XII.33, pp. 621.24–623.2, and John of Antioch frs. 251.2, 252, 253 (ed. Roberto) with Eutropius X.1, 3 and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 145–146 (noting possible explanations for Zonaras' apparently inaccurate name for one of Constantius' sons).

126 Cf. Zonaras XII.33–34, pp. 623.3–625.12, with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 146–147.

127 See Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 194: "Zonaras, Cedrenus, and Scutariotes all reflect complex biographical and hagiographical traditions that begin with Eusebius' *Life of Constantine* and the lost work of Praxagoras .... However, rather than these biographies, it is some of the content of the so-called Opitz and Guida [read "Guidi"] *Lives*, as distinct from these specific *Lives* themselves, that provides the greatest number of significant points of contact with Zonaras." On these and other biographies of Constantine, see S. Lieu,

appears at this point in some manuscripts of Zonaras but not others, recording the succession of bishops at Rome, Antioch, and Alexandria on the basis of Eusebius' *Ecclesiastical History*.[128]

This lost biography of Constantine is probably the source of the greater part of the rest of Zonaras' account of Constantine's reign, but not of all of it. Zonaras also adds comments of his own, probably a little information from Philostorgius, and citations by name of Cassius Dio, Eusebius' *Ecclesiastical History*, the acts of the Council of Nicaea (apparently meaning a work by Gelasius of Cyzicus), and Julian's *Caesars*.[129] Yet some elements of Zonaras' account seem to be inserted from an earlier and probably pagan source that was presumably Ammianus, including a note that according to some Constantine's mother Helen was not married to his father and a description of Constantine's wars with Licinius.[130]

Finally, the end of Zonaras' account is a sort of obituary of Constantine in the style of Ammianus' obituaries of later emperors. This passage shows parallels with both Eutropius and John of Antioch and includes the citation from Julian's *Caesars*, which criticizes Constantine's extravagance in terms that Ammianus would have approved.[131] The parallel to Zonaras in John of Antioch mentions Constantine's killing "the son of his sister Commoda," which is evidently Eustathius' misunderstanding of a phrase like that in Eutropius noting that Constantine killed "his sister's son, a youth of agreeable character (*sororis filium commodae indolis iuvenem*)."[132] Yet this cannot be taken as proof that

---

D. Montserrat, *From Constantine to Julian: Pagan and Byzantine Views: A Source History* (London: Routledge, 1996), pp. 97–106, with an annotated translation of the Guidi life on pp. 106–146.

128 Cf. Zonaras XII.34, pp. 625.12–628.19, with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 147, who suggest that this section may be a later interpolation into Zonaras' work.

129 Cf. Zonaras XIII.1–4 and John of Antioch frs. 254–256 (ed. Roberto) with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 189–208. On Gelasius of Cyzicus' work entitled *Acts of the Council of Nicaea*, see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 165–166. For Zonaras' use of Philostorgius on Constantine's death, see M. DiMaio, "Zonaras, Julian, and Philostorgios on the Death of the Emperor Constantine I," *Greek Orthodox Theological Review* 26 (1981): pp. 118–124.

130 Zonaras XIII.1.4, 21–29; cf. Symeon the Logothete 88.2–3. The identification of this pagan source was made by B. Bleckmann, "Die Chronik des Johannes Zonaras und eine pagane Quelle zur Geschichte Konstantins," *Historia* 40 (1991): pp. 343–365, who refers to Symeon as "Leo Grammaticus," since at the time Wahlgren's edition of Symeon: *Symeonis Magistri et Logothetae Chronicon* I, ed. S. Wahlgren (Berlin: de Gruyter, 2006) had not yet appeared. "Leo Grammaticus" was one of several copyists of Symeon's chronicle.

131 Cf. Zonaras XIII.4.29–34 and John of Antioch frs. 254, 255 (ed. Roberto) with Eutropius X.6.3–8.1 and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 208.

132 Cf. John of Antioch fr. 254.1–2 (ed. Roberto) with Eutropius X.6.3 and DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection," pp. 167–168.

Eustathius copied Eutropius. If Eutropius and Ammianus both closely followed the *Kaisergeschichte*, Ammianus could have borrowed these words from it just as Eutropius did, perhaps in an even more easily misunderstood form.

George Cedrenus (or Pseudo-Symeon) adds a story about Constantine not mentioned by Zonaras that probably derives from Ammianus and Eustathius by way of a mostly lost passage of John of Antioch. According to Cedrenus, Metrodorus, a philosopher who had traveled in India, gave Constantine a gift of Indian jewels and pearls but claimed that the Persians had stolen others from him; when Constantine unsuccessfully demanded these treasures from Sapor II, war with Persia resulted. Cedrenus goes on to say that Constantine sent some of his jewels to the barbarians across the Danube, a report paralleled among the fragments of John of Antioch, and that Constantine was the first emperor to wear a diadem decorated with pearls and jewels, a report paralleled in Pseudo-Aurelius, another user of the *Kaisergeschichte*. Almost conclusively, Ammianus states in Book XXV that war had first broken out between Rome and Persia because Constantine "greedily accepted the lies of Metrodorus, as we have earlier related in full," obviously in one of the lost books.[133]

As for Malalas, his treatment of this period is badly muddled by his usual inventions of physical descriptions of the emperors, his confusing the emperors with each other (partly because he was misled by Eustathius), and especially his fixed idea that the simultaneous imperial reigns from 285 to 324 occurred sequentially.[134] Nevertheless, Malalas supplies us with our best data for the ages when these emperors died: Diocletian at 72, Maximian at 57, Constantius I at 60, Galerius (confused with Maxentius) at 53, Maximinus (confused with Licinius) at 46, and Constantine at 60 years and 3 months (which can be corrected from Zonaras and other Byzantine historians to 65 years).[135] Since we have seen that Ammianus was careful to record emperors' ages at their deaths, he is the most likely source of these ages, even when they have been

133 Cf. Cedrenus I, pp. 516.12–517.9 (where Cedrenus' date is presumably one of the fictions of Pseudo-Symeon) with John of Antioch fr. 255 (ed. Roberto), Pseudo-Aurelius XLI.14, Ammianus XXV.23, Dodgeon, Lieu, *The Roman Eastern Frontier*, pp. 153, 381, and *Prosopography*, Metrodorus 1. Cedrenus I, p. 517.9–11, describes Constantine's donating to "the Great Church" Gospels decorated with pearls and jewels in a passage that seems less likely to derive from Ammianus.

134 Malalas XVIII.8 shows that he later discovered his chronological mistakes, but without bothering to rectify them; cf. Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 249–250.

135 Malalas XII.44 (Diocletian), XII.46 (Maximian), XII.47 (Galerius, not Maxentius), XII.48 (Constantius I), XII.50 (Maximinus, not Licinius), and XIII.14 (Constantine I; emend to ξε′ from the texts listed on p. 543 with n. 53 above); see Barnes, *The New Empire*, p. 46; Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 318–319, n. 31; and *idem*, *The Middle*, p. 395, n. 34.

attached to material that has nothing to do with his work. The only one of these emperors for whom Eutropius records an age at death is Constantine, giving an age of 66, which is correct if counted inclusively but a different number from that evidently recorded by Eustathius, and therefore probably derived from a different source.[136]

Why would Eustathius have relied on Ammianus for most of his account of secular events from the accession of Diocletian up to the accession of Constantine, but then adopted the lost life of Constantine in preference to Ammianus? One obvious reason is that Eustathius thought Ammianus, as a pagan, gave insufficiently favorable treatment to Constantine's conversion and merits. Yet we also have grounds to think that Ammianus' treatment of this period was not very expansive, because if it had been Eustathius would probably have found more of interest in it to summarize. For the reign of Diocletian, Ammianus appears to have included around twice as much information as is to be found in Eutropius, who was also a pagan and a user of the *Kaisergeschichte*. Ammianus had no apparent motive to give much more voluminous treatment when he came to the reign of Constantine, whom he would not have treated with enthusiasm but could not have criticized freely when he wrote under Valentinian II. The conclusion that Ammianus gave much less attention to the years from 284 to 337 than to the succeeding period helps to confirm the usual assumptions that Ammianus' earlier books were much less detailed than his later ones and that Ammianus was primarily a contemporary historian.

VI

In looking for fragments of Ammianus' history before 284, we should probably give up searching the part of Zonaras' narrative before the concluding date of Dio's history in 229, since Ammianus cannot have had much to add to the information Zonaras and Eustathius found in Dio and in Zonaras' source derived from Eusebius of Caesarea. We know in fact that Zonaras in his earlier books relied heavily on Dio's history, for which he is one of our main sources of fragments.[137] After our fully preserved text of Dio ends with 46 A.D., we depend mostly on John Xiphilinus' epitome of it, which was only about a quarter as long as the original.[138] Therefore Zonaras' source for any otherwise unattested information is likely to have been the full text of Dio, not the lost books of

136 Eutropius x.8.2.

137 On Zonaras' earlier use of Dio, see Treadgold, *The Middle*, p. 394.

138 On Xiphilinus' epitome of Dio, see Treadgold, *The Middle*, pp. 310–312.

Ammianus. Dio himself regularly recorded the ages of the emperors at their deaths, which Zonaras evidently repeats from him. What is striking is that the obituary chronicle, as reflected in Malalas and Scutariotes, seems to have differed significantly from Dio and Zonaras on the death dates of emperors before 238, even though most of these dates are not preserved in both traditions for comparison.

For example, according to Zonaras and to Xiphilinus' epitome of Dio, Hadrian (117–138) died at the age of 62 years, 5 months, and 19 days, but according to both Malalas and Scutariotes Hadrian died at 65.[139] According to Zonaras and to Xiphilinus' epitome of Dio, Commodus (180–192) died at the age of 31 years and 4 months, but according to Scutariotes at 41.[140] According to Zonaras and Xiphilinus' epitome of Dio, Pertinax (193) died 4 months short of the age of 67, but according to both Malalas and Scutariotes Pertinax died at 70.[141] Admittedly, sometimes the ages given in both traditions are compatible. Thus according to Zonaras and Xiphilinus' epitome of Dio, Didius Julianus (193) died at the age of 60 years, 4 months, and 4 days (Xiphilinus omits the days), which is differently expressed but compatible with Malalas' and Scutariotes' age of a round 60.[142] According to Zonaras and Xiphilinus' epitome of Dio, Septimius Severus died at the age of 65 years, 9 months, and 29 days (Xiphilinus says 25 days), which is compatible with Malalas' 65 years.[143] (Our abridged fragments of John of Antioch include no such ages from 96 to 229.) Yet where Malalas and Scutariotes differ from Dio on these ages, or even in the form in which they are expressed, their source was presumably Eustathius (in Scutariotes' case by way of John of Antioch), and Eustathius' source was probably Ammianus.[144] Given the fragmentary state of our texts of both Dio and John of Antioch, the fictional elaborations of Malalas, and the extreme compression of Scutariotes and other Byzantine chronicles, we cannot be sure exactly how independent Eustathius and Ammianus were from Dio; but Eustathius clearly depended less on Dio than on Herodian's history once it begins with 180.[145] We seem to be left with no clear evidence that Ammianus used Dio.

---

139 Cf. Zonaras XI.24, p. 521.16–17, and Dio LXIX.23.1 with Malalas XI.20 and Scutariotes, p. 31.14.

140 Cf. Zonaras XII.5, p. 538.12–13, and Dio LXXIII.22.6 with Scutariotes, p. 32.22–23.

141 Cf. Zonaras XII.6, p. 542.13, and Dio LXXIV.10.3 with Malalas XII.14 and Scutariotes, p. 32.26.

142 Cf. Zonaras XII.7, p. 545.22–23, and Dio LXXIV.17.5 with Malalas XII.17 and Scutariotes, p. 32.29.

143 Cf. Zonaras XII.10, pp. 555.21–556.2, and Dio LXXVII.17.4 with Malalas XII.22.

144 For full references to these ages in Malalas and Scutariotes, see the appendix to the present article.

145 See John of Antioch, frs. 191–219 (ed. Roberto) with the parallels noted in Roberto's apparatus.

After Dio's history ended with 229, Zonaras obviously needed to rely on other sources. A comparison of parallel texts indicates that he relied mainly on the full text of John of Antioch, who copied Eustathius. A recent study has tentatively concluded "that the close correspondences between Zonaras, Herodian, and Eusebius result from Zonaras' use of an intermediate chronological source that integrated secular and ecclesiastical events and that itself depended for secular events from ca. 222 up to ca. 238 on a tradition that derived, in part, from Herodian."[146] This intermediate source was evidently John of Antioch's copy of the history of Eustathius. Most scholars believe that some of Ammianus' references to his lost books show that he depended on Herodian, though some have doubted this.[147] Herodian's history concludes with 238.

From 229 to 238 Zonaras and Scutariotes still record the ages of emperors at their deaths, which are as a rule not noted in Herodian's history. Although our abridged fragments of John of Antioch include no ages for the half-dozen emperors of this period and there is a lacuna in Malalas' text at this point, we have ages for all six emperors if we put together our information from Zonaras and Scutariotes. According to Scutariotes, Severus Alexander (222–235) died at 39, which is perhaps an error for 29.[148] According to Zonaras, Maximinus Thrax (235–238) died at 65, and Scutariotes' 60 is probably just a corruption of this.[149] According to both Zonaras and Scutariotes, Gordian I (238) died at 79.[150] According to Scutariotes, Gordian II (238) died at 50.[151] Finally, Zonaras says that Pupienus Maximus (238) died at 74 and his colleague Balbinus (also 238)

146 Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 73; cf. p. 79: "Parallels again suggest Zonaras' dependence on an intermediate source rather than his direct consultation of Herodian and Eusebius [of Caesarea], the ultimate sources of much of the information he transmits." L. Mecella, "Malalas und die Quellen für die Zeit der Soldatenkaiser," in Carrara et al., *Weltchronik*, pp. 73–98, argues that for the third century, besides Eustathius, Malalas used another source derived from the *Kaisergeschichte*; without sharing her faith in some of Hans Thurn's reconstructions of the lacuna in our text of Malalas from 211 to 253, I agree that Malalas used a source derived from the *Kaisergeschichte*—namely Ammianus.

147 For the case that Ammianus depended on Herodian, see J.F. Gilliam, "Ammianus and the Historia Augusta: The Lost Books and the Period 117–285," in *Bonner Historia-Augusta-Colloquium 1970* (Bonn, 1972): pp. 125–147, accepted by Barnes, *Ammianus*, p. 213, partly accepted by Matthews, *The Roman Empire*, p. 482, n. 42, but disputed by M.F.A. Brok, "Un malentendu tenace (les rapports entre Hérodien et Ammien Marcellin)," *Revue des Études Anciennes* 78/79 (1976/77): pp. 199–207, who actually demonstrates only that Ammianus used other sources along with Herodian.

148 Scutariotes, p. 35.15 (for λθ′ read κθ′).

149 Zonaras XII.16, p. 578.9–10, and Scutariotes, p. 36.11 (for ἑξήκοντα read ἑξήκοντα ⟨ἓξ⟩).

150 Zonaras XII.17, p. 579.19–20, and Scutariotes, p. 36.16.

151 Scutariotes, p. 36.19.

at 60.[152] While the indirect source of these ages was presumably the conjectural obituary chronicle, Eustathius' direct source is likely to have been Ammianus, because, as we have seen, the list of the emperors' ages evidently reached Ammianus' time and was not reflected in the *Kaisergeschichte*.

From 229 to 238 Zonaras' account mostly summarizes Herodian with some additions derived from Eusebius of Caesarea. Here Eustathius seems to have consulted Herodian's history directly, because if he had merely made a Greek summary of Ammianus' summary of it in Latin, Zonaras and John of Antioch would not show the clear verbal parallels with Herodian that they do, including Gordian I's reference to himself as "about 80," which conflicts slightly with the obituary chronicle's putting his age at 79.[153] Yet Zonaras includes three items not recorded by Herodian or Eusebius: that the Persian king Artaxerxes invaded Cappadocia and besieged Nisibis around 230, that the emperor Maximinus killed his own wife, and that "some write" that "a certain Pompeianus" was emperor briefly between the emperors "Maximus" and "Albinus" and another emperor, "Publius Balbinus."[154]

This last item, also found in Scutariotes, evidently resulted from a failure to recognize either "Albinus" and Balbinus or "Pompeianus" and Pupienus as the same emperor.[155] The obituary chronicle seems not to have shared this confusion, because it apparently recorded only two ages at death for Pupienus Maximus and Balbinus and their two doublets. Since this mistake seems to have been a blundering attempt to combine the accounts of the *Kaisergeschichte* and the obituary chronicle, it must go back to Eustathius and probably goes back to Ammianus. The mention of Nisibis also probably goes back to Ammianus, whose own experiences gave him an interest in the Persian frontier and in Nisibis in particular. Ammianus mentions in Book XIV having said in a lost book that Maximinus' wife had tried to restrain her husband from his cru-

152 Zonaras XII.17, p. 579.4–5 (referring to "Maximus" and "Albinus"). Zonaras calls Balbinus "Albinus" (except at p. 579.14, where he calls him "Balbinus" without realizing that he was the same emperor) and Scutariotes, p. 36.10, 13, calls him "Galbius" and "Galbinus," though John of Antioch fr. 224 (ed. Roberto) correctly calls him Balbinus.

153 Cf., e.g., the quotation from the Persian ambassadors in Zonaras XII.15, p. 573.8–11, with Herodian VI.4.5, Gordian's proclamation with the mention of his age in John of Antioch fr. 224.32–37 (ed. Roberto) with Herodian VII.5.1–2, and the death of the city prefect Sabinus after the lacuna in John of Antioch fr. 224.38–43 (ed. Roberto) with Herodian VII.7.4–5.

154 Cf. Zonaras XII.15–17, pp. 573.1–580.6, and John of Antioch frs. 219–224 (ed. Roberto) with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 77–89, especially nn. 6, 16, 24 (where for "Herodian VIII.9.7–9" read "Herodian VII.9.7–9"). At Zonaras XII.16, p. 578.2–3, the remark, "Aquileia is said to be today's Venice," must be an addition by Zonaras himself.

155 Cf. Zonaras XII.17, p. 579.2–14, with Scutariotes, p. 36.10–13 (referring to "Maximus" and "Galbius" and "Pompianus" and "Publius Galbinus").

elty (perhaps provoking him to kill her), while in Book XXVI Ammianus says that Gordian I hanged himself, a fact recorded by Herodian, Zonaras, and a fragment of John of Antioch.[156] The report that Maximinus killed his wife is repeated by George Syncellus, presumably following John of Antioch, who followed Eustathius.[157] Here Eustathius must have combined material derived from Eusebius with both Herodian and Ammianus.

If Eustathius supplemented Herodian with another source than Ammianus, the obvious candidate would be Dexippus, whose history reached 270. Yet we can be reasonably sure that Eustathius knew Ammianus' lost books, while Eustathius seems unlikely to have known Dexippus' history directly. Zonaras' account of this period would surely be less confused than it is if Eustathius had had direct access to Dexippus' history, which was detailed, more or less contemporary, and written in Eustathius' native language of Greek, and discussed events both before and after the accession of Gordian III in 238.[158] Much of this confusion apparently arose because, as we have seen, the *Kaisergeschichte*, as represented by Eutropius and Victor, assumed that Gordian II and Gordian III were the same man.[159] Since both Zonaras and Scutariotes recognize the existence of three emperors named Gordian, Eustathius and Ammianus must have realized it as well; but Ammianus would still have been puzzled by the mistake in the *Kaisergeschichte*. The fact that Zonaras refers to differing accounts of Gordian I's death could mean that Eustathius had compared Ammianus and Herodian, but could also mean that Eustathius was copying Ammianus, who either mentioned the discrepancy himself or copied a reference to it from the *Kaisergeschichte*. Since Ammianus gave variant accounts of the death of his contemporary Jovian, he should not have been reluctant to give variant accounts of events of the more distant past.[160]

156 Ammianus XIV.1.8, XXVI.6.20.

157 George Syncellus A.M. 5728, p. 442.10–11.

158 See Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 82–88, who begin their discussion with the well-justified remark, "The source tradition or traditions that Zonaras reflects are both confused and confusing."

159 See Eutropius IX.2 and Aurelius Victor 27. Unlike Rohrbacher, "The Sources," pp. 111–112, I doubt that this error was shared by Ammianus, who in XXIII.5.17 refers to Gordian III as *iunior Gordianus* and in XXVI.6.20 to Gordian I as *superior Gordianus*. In his actual narrative Ammianus could easily have made it clear that there were three Gordians, perhaps by referring to Gordian II as *senior Gordianus*.

160 Ammianus XV.10.13.

VII

From 238 to 270, between the end of Herodian's history and the end of Dexippus' history, Malalas, Zonaras, and Scutariotes again record each emperor's age at his death, if we put the evidence of all three historians together. According to Scutariotes, Gordian III (238–244) died at 28, Philip the Arab (244–249) at 63, and Decius (249–251) at 60; between Gordian III and Philip, Scutariotes also includes two dubious ephemeral emperors, Marcus and Hostilianus Severus, who supposedly died aged 43 and 46 respectively.[161] The Constantinian *Excerpts* from Malalas confirm Scutariotes' ages for Philip and Decius and say that Trebonianus Gallus (251–253) also died at 60.[162] Malalas says that Aemilianus (253) died at 47, which John of Antioch may have miscopied from Eustathius as 40, the age recorded by Zonaras and Scutariotes.[163] Malalas says Valerian (253–260) died at 61.[164] Malalas and Scutariotes agree that Gallienus (260–268) died at 50, Claudius II (268–270) at 56, and Quintillus (270) at 41.[165] The evidence therefore continues to support the existence of an obituary chronicle, whether accurate or not.

After the end of Herodian's history in 238, Zonaras' account shows clear parallels with that of Zosimus, but since Zonaras includes many additional events and details he must depend not on Zosimus but on Zosimus' source, evidently Dexippus or another historian who used Dexippus.[166] In fact, in a parallel passage evidently taken from John of Antioch, George Syncellus cites Dexippus by name as a source for the reign of Trebonianus Gallus, and the list of sources that Evagrius evidently took from Eustathius includes Dexippus.[167] Zosimus in turn includes many events and details that are not in Zonaras. Yet given that Zonaras often follows Zosimus sentence by sentence, the absence of verbal parallels is remarkable, extending repeatedly to different Greek transliterations of Latin names.[168] This is of course just what we would expect if

161 Scutariotes, pp. 36.31 (Gordian III), 37.2 (Marcus), 37.4 (Hostilianus), 37.17 (Philip), 37.30 (Decius).

162 Malalas XII.25, p. 227, XIIIc (Philip), XVb (Gallus), XVIIe (Decius) in Thurn's edition, where our main ms. has a lacuna.

163 Malalas XII.25, Zonaras XII.22, p. 592.3–4, and Scutariotes, p. 38.13–14.

164 Malalas XII.26.

165 Malalas XII.27, XII.28, XII.29 and Scutariotes, pp. 38.29, 39.3, 39.8.

166 Cf. Zonaras XII.18–20, pp. 581.17–583.9, 584.1–585.5, 589.3–14 with Zosimus I.17.2–23.3, Zonaras XII.21–23, pp. 589.15–589.22, 589.24–592.5, 593.3–596.9 with Zosimus I.24.1–30.1, 36.1–2, and Zonaras XII.24–26, pp. 596.15–603.6, 603.22–606.6 with Zosimus I.30.1–3, 38.1–44.1, 46.1–47.1.

167 George Syncellus A.M. 5746, p. 459.13–16; Evagrius V.24.

168 Cf. Zonaras XII.21, p. 589.16 (Βολουσιανὸν; cf. John of Antioch fr. 229 [ed. Roberto]), XII.23,

Ammianus translated material from a Greek history into Latin and Eustathius then summarized Ammianus' Latin in Greek. The *Kaisergeschichte*, to judge from Eutropius and Victor, had much less to say about this period than did Zonaras' and Eustathius' source, who was apparently Ammianus, combining information directly or indirectly from Dexippus with the *Kaisergeschichte* and the obituary chronicle. If so, Zonaras preserves considerably more of the contemporary part of Dexippus' history than previous scholars have thought has survived.[169]

As before, Zonaras' account of the reigns of Gordian III, Philip, and Decius combines secular and Christian material, all evidently taken from Eustathius by way of John of Antioch.[170] Since Eustathius and his source were combining different sources, both of them not surprisingly became confused, as did Zonaras and Scutariotes later. Zonaras confusedly gives two versions of the death of Gordian III as if he had been two different emperors named Gordian, one who died after falling from his horse on a Persian campaign and the other who was killed because of a plot by Philip the Arab on a Persian campaign. The story of the plot was presumably accurate and reported by Dexippus and the *Kaisergeschichte*. By process of elimination, the story of the accident, probably circulated by Philip to exculpate himself, evidently came from the obituary chronicle. Zonaras separates these two versions from each other with a passage from his source based on Eusebius of Caesarea.[171] While Scutariotes, George

---

p. 592.20 (Γαλιήνῳ), XII.24, p. 596.19 (τὰ Μεδιόλανα), XII.24, p. 596.20 (Αἰρούλοις; cf. George Syncellus A.M. 5748, p. 467.15, Αἴλουροι), XII.26 (Κυντιλιανὸν; cf. John of Antioch fr. 234 [ed. Roberto], Κυντίλιος and George Syncellus A.M. 5763, p. 469.21–22, Κεντίλλιος) with Zosimus 1.24.1 (Οὐολουσιανὸν), 30.1 (Γαλλιηνὸν), 40.1 (Μεδιολάνῳ), 42.1 (Ἐρούλους), 47.1 (Κυντίλλου). Note also that in Scutariotes, p. 38.22, the city of Salona (Σάλονα) is a misunderstanding of the name of Gallienus' son Saloninus (Zosimus 1.38.2, Σαλωνῖνος), while Zonaras XII.24, p. 597 has somehow misunderstood that the son (unnamed by Scutariotes) had the same name as his father (ὁμώνυμον). The few verbal resemblances between Zosimus on the one hand and Zonaras, John of Antioch, George Syncellus, and Scutariotes on the other seem to be merely coincidental.

169 See F. Millar, "P. Herrenius Dexippus: The Greek World and the Third-Century Invasions," *Journal of Roman Studies* 59 (1969): pp. 12–29, especially pp. 21–24, on the scantiness of our other fragments of Dexippus and the dubious quality of those in the *Historia Augusta*. More recently, see P. Janiszewski, *The Missing Link: Greek Pagan Historiography in the Second Half of the Third Century and in the Fourth Century AD* (Warsaw: Warsaw University, 2006), pp. 39–54, and L. Mecella, *Dexippo di Atene: Testimonianze e frammenti* (Tivoli: Edizioni Tored, 2013).

170 Cf. Zonaras XII.19–20, pp. 583.1–589.14, with John of Antioch frs. 226, 227 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5731, p. 443.3–9, A.M. 5737, p. 444.16–18, A.M. 5746, p. 459.5–13, and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 91–100.

171 Cf. Zonaras XII.17, pp. 580.7–14 (the death of Gordian III after falling from his horse),

the Monk, and George Cedrenus adopt the story of the accident, a fragment of John of Antioch, George Syncellus, Eutropius, Victor, and Pseudo-Aurelius all adopt the story of the plot.[172] The explanation may well be that Ammianus, realizing from Dexippus and the obituary chronicle that there had been three Gordians and trying to reconcile this with the two Gordians mentioned in the *Kaisergeschichte*, assigned the two versions of Gordian III's death to different Gordians; then Eustathius, uneasy with this awkward solution, tried to distract his readers from it by inserting the Eusebian material between the two versions of the death; then George the Monk and George Cedrenus chose the first version from John of Antioch while Scutariotes and George Syncellus chose the second.

Much like the "Pompeianus" who was evidently a doublet of Pupienus, the mentions of "Marcus" and "Hostilianus Severus" may reflect confused reports about Philip's son Marcus and Decius' son Hostilianus.[173] Yet unlike "Pompeianus," about whom even Zonaras expresses doubts (possibly copied from Ammianus by way of Eustathius), in our texts based on Eustathius both Marcus and Hostilianus are assigned their own ages at death and brief biographies, which may be practically all that the obituary chronicle said about them. Zonaras and Scutariotes agree that on hearing of Gordian's death in the East the senate at Rome elected Marcus, a "philosopher," who died almost at once in the palace, and that Hostilianus Severus then became emperor but died almost immediately while being bled for a disease.[174] Even if what the obituary chron-

---

580.15–581.16 (a passage derived from Eusebius), XII.18, pp. 581.17–582.13 (the murder of Gordian by Philip) with Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 88–91.

172 Cf. George the Monk, p. 461.13–15, and George Cedrenus I, p. 451.11–12, with John of Antioch fr. 225 (ed. Roberto), Scutariotes, p. 36, George Syncellus A.M. 5731, p. 443.3–9, Eutropius IX.2.3, Aurelius Victor 27.8, and Pseudo-Aurelius XXVII. Note that if John of Antioch, like Zonaras, included both versions, the Constantinian excerptors for "On Plots against Monarchs" would still have omitted the story of the accident, because it involved no plot against a monarch.

173 See Banchich and Lane, *The History*, p. 91, and M. Peachin, *Roman Imperial Titulature and Chronology, A.D. 235–284* (Amsterdam: J.C. Gieben, 1990), p. 198 (showing that both Philip and his son Philip were named Marcus), 33–34; 255–258, 261–265 (on Hostilianus, who was however not named Severus). Scutariotes, p. 37.10–11, is an incomplete reference to a "Marius" hastily proclaimed by the senate after Philip but may actually refer to the Marinus who briefly rebelled against Philip according to Zonaras XII.19, p. 584.2–8, and Zosimus I.20.2. Malalas XII.25, p. 227, XVIb in Thurn's edition (from the Constantinian *Excerpts* "On Plots") refers to the Marius who according to John of Antioch fr. 230 (ed. Roberto), Eutropius IX.9.2, and Aurelius Victor 33.9–12 was proclaimed and then killed by the army in Gaul after the death of the usurper Postumus; on that Marius, who was also named Marcus, see Peachin, *Roman Imperial Titulature*, p. 484.

174 Cf. Zonaras XII.18, p. 582.14–21, with Scutariotes, pp. 36.31–37.

icle said about these ephemeral emperors was mostly invented, it was not so implausible that Ammianus would have felt compelled to reject it.

Zonaras' accounts of the reigns of Trebonianus Gallus and Aemilianus similarly seem to combine Dexippus, the *Kaisergeschichte*, and the obituary chronicle, punctuated by some Christian material. Zonaras then moves on to the reign of Valerian and the Persian invasion that followed Valerian's defeat and capture, before including more Christian material.[175] Zonaras' account of the tumultuous reign of Gallienus concludes once more with a little Christian material. Then come accounts of the reigns of Claudius II and the ephemeral Quintillus, spelled "Quintilianus" by Zonaras and Scutariotes but "Quintillius" by John of Antioch and George Syncellus.[176] After a single citation of Eusebius, Zonaras' report that Constantine's father Constantius I ("Constans") was the grandson of Claudius II by his daughter, though presumably invented to lend legitimacy to the house of Constantine, is paralleled in Eutropius and probably in Victor, and therefore derives from the *Kaisergeschichte*.[177] Ammianus would presumably have seen no reason to omit it.

For the period from 270 to 284, Malalas and Scutariotes, doubtless following the obituary chronicle, generally agree about the ages at which the emperors died. According to Malalas, Aurelian (270–275) died at 61, Tacitus (275–276) at 75, Florianus (276) at 65, Probus (276–282) at 50, Carus (282–283) at 60 "and a half," Numerian (283–284) at 36, and Carinus (283–285) at 32.[178] While Scutariotes' 60 for Aurelian is probably a copyist's error for Malalas' 61, Scutariotes agrees with Malalas' ages for Tacitus and Probus, rounds off Malalas' 60 and a half for Carus to just 60, and agrees with Malalas' age for Numerian.[179] Zonaras' account of the reign of Aurelian is briefly interrupted toward the beginning by

175 Cf. Zonaras XII.21–23 with John of Antioch frs. 228, 229 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5746, p. 459.13–17, A.M. 5748, pp. 465.20–466.23, Scutariotes, pp. 37.31–38.19, and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 100–170.

176 Cf. Zonaras XII.24–26 with John of Antioch frs. 230–235 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5748, pp. 466.23–467.28, A.M. 5763, p. 469.17–22, Scutariotes, pp. 38.20–39.8, and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 109–122.

177 Eutropius IX.22.1 and Aurelius Victor 34.6–7 (where the lacuna after *Constantius et Constantinus atque imperatores nostri* presumably referred to their descent from Claudius, the subject of the chapter). If we follow the obituary chronicle, Claudius was born ca. 214 and Constantius was born ca. 246, so that a daughter of Claudius and mother of Constantius could conceivably have been born ca. 230; but few ancient or medieval readers would have had the critical sense to check such data.

178 Malalas XII.30 (Aurelian), XII.31 (Tacitus), XII.32 (Florianus), XII.33 (Probus), XII.34 (Carus), XII.35 (Numerian), XII.36 (Carinus).

179 Scutariotes, pp. 39.16 (Aurelian), 39.20 (Tacitus), 40.4–5 (Probus), 40.8 ("Sarus" = Carus), 40.13 (Numerian).

a short passage of Christian material. Then the reigns of Aurelian, Tacitus, Florianus, Probus, Carus, Numerian, and Carinus are described without anything else that is obviously an insertion.[180] Zonaras mentions varying accounts of the length of Tacitus' reign and the deaths of Carus and Numerian, and expresses disbelief that grain fell from the heavens to feed Probus' army. Although these could be Eustathius' comments on different sources, they seem more likely to be comments by Ammianus. For example, according to Zonaras some said that Aurelian brought Zenobia from Palmyra back to Rome (the version of the *Kaisergeschichte*), while others said that she died on the way (the version of Zosimus/Eunapius).[181] Ammianus would presumably have found both versions and mentioned them. Finally, after another interpolation from Christian sources, Zonaras reaches the accession of Diocletian.

A comparison of Zonaras with Zosimus again indicates a common source, also with only insignificant and probably coincidental verbal parallels.[182] If the explanation given above for the years from 238 to 270 is right, the reason for the lack of verbal parallels is that Zosimus' source had been translated into Latin by Ammianus and summarized back into Greek by Eustathius before Zonaras used it. Yet this time the common source cannot have been Dexippus' history, which had ended with 270. While Eunapius did continue Dexippus, the first installment of Eunapius' history seems to have appeared around 397, later than Ammianus' first installment around 390.[183] Although the suggestion has recently been made that Eunapius' first installment appeared a few years before Ammianus's, this case is far from proven, and even if correct would not prove that a copy of Eunapius' history arrived promptly from his home in Sardis to Ammianus' home in Rome.[184] A much more likely explanation is that for this period Ammianus shared a source with Eunapius, who must have had a written source, because he wrote in plausible detail on events that had occurred more than a century before he wrote.[185]

---

180 Cf. Zonaras XII.27–30 with John of Antioch frs. 235–246 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5764, pp. 469.25–470.15, A.M. 5765, pp. 470.24–471.3, A.M. 5770, p. 471.11–15, A.M. 5776, p. 472.9–26, Scutariotes, pp. 39.9–40.26, and Banchich and Lane, *The History*, pp. 122–134.

181 Cf. Zonaras XII.27, pp. 607.6–11, with Eutropius IX.13.2 and Zosimus I.59.

182 Cf. Zonaras XII.27–30, pp. 606.7–14, 607.1–612.7, with Zosimus I.50.1–2, 56.1–2, 59, 61.2–67.2.

183 See Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 58–59 (Ammianus), 81–83 (Eunapius).

184 See Cameron, *The Last Pagans*, pp. 672–673.

185 This source is unlikely to be Heliconius of Byzantium, who since his history ended with 379 would also have needed a written source for the years from 270 to 284. On Heliconius, see Treadgold, *The Early*, pp. 48–49, except that I now withdraw my suggested identification of

If we consult the same list of sources that Evagrius evidently repeated from Eustathius, the obvious candidate to be Ammianus' and Zosimus' shared source is the obscure pagan historian Eusebius (different, of course, from the Christian Eusebius of Caesarea). Evagrius mentions him just after Dexippus, attributing to Eusebius a history running from "Octavian" to the death of Carus (283).[186] Two fragments, probably from the Constantinian *Excerpts*, survive from Eusebius' history, one assigned to "Book IX" on a "Scythian" siege of Thessalonica and the other on a siege of a city in Gaul, probably Tours.[187] Both Zonaras and Zosimus mention two "Scythian" sieges of Thessalonica, the first under Valerian and the second under Claudius, though which of these Eusebius described, and which siege in Gaul, is uncertain.[188] If Eusebius' Book IX reached the reigns of Valerian or Claudius, it was most likely the final book, especially because Eusebius, an imitator of Herodotus who wrote in the Ionic dialect, might well have divided his history into nine books like those of Herodotus. Nine books for more than three hundred years implies quite concise treatment, summarizing and continuing Dexippus' history and probably serving as Ammianus' source for Dexippus. In any case, Eustathius' reference to this Eusebius, like his reference to Dexippus, was presumably copied not from the original work but from a reference to it in a source, in this case Ammianus.

---

his history as the *Anonymus post Dionem*, ed. C. Müller (Fragmenta Historicorum Graecorum IV; Paris, 1868), pp. 191–199), which is now securely attributed to Peter the Patrician by T. Banchich, *The Lost History of Peter the Patrician: An Account of Rome's Imperial Past from the Age of Justinian* (London: Routledge, 2015), especially pp. 6–9. Moreover, the Anonymous shows clear verbal parallels with Zonaras: cf. *Anonymus* fr. 9.1 with Zonaras XII.26, p. 605.1–6; and *Anonymus* fr. 10.1 with Zonaras XII.27, p. 606.7–13.

186 Evagrius V.24. On this Eusebius, see B. Baldwin, "Eusebius and the Siege of Thessalonica," *Rheinisches Museum für Philologie* 124 (1981): pp. 291–296, and especially Janiszewki, *The Missing Link*, pp. 54–77 (though his tentative identification of the historian as the consul for 359 seems too late for a writer who concluded his history with 283).

187 Ed. in Jacoby, *FGrHist* IIA, no. 101. That these excerpts came from the Constantinian collection has been doubted, but is convincingly argued by Németh, *Imperial Systematization*, pp. 145–177 (mentioning Eusebius on p. 153).

188 Cf. Zonaras XII.23, p. 593.4–6 (under Valerian), XII.26 pp. 604.20–605.2 (under Claudius, with a note on the derivation of the name of Thessalonica that may well be Ammianus' addition) with Zosimus I.29.2 (under Valerian), 43.1 (under Claudius, without the derivation). Eusebius' second description of a siege could apply to Gallienus' siege of "a certain city of Gaul" held by Postumus (Zonaras XII.24, p. 598.14–18). The references to the sieges in Zonaras and Zosimus are so condensed that we should not expect them to show parallels with Eusebius' descriptions.

VIII

In sum, the balance of probability is that Ammianus was the principal source of Eustathius, John of Antioch, Zonaras, and Scutariotes for the whole period from 229 to 364, and sometimes as early as 96. Although the reign of Constantine I from 306 to 337 would be an exception, even for that period the quantity of material that Eustathius took from his biography of Constantine was not necessarily much more or less than what Eustathius was accustomed to take from Ammianus' history when he used it. Nonetheless, the supposition that Eustathius summarized Ammianus (and Zonaras summarized Eustathius) at the same rate throughout the period of Ammianus' history would lead to the impossible conclusion that Ammianus covered the years from 229 to 353 in some forty-five books, not including the 133 years he covered before 229. The book numbers in our manuscripts indicate that Ammianus covered this whole span in just thirteen books, and even those scholars who want to renumber his books have suggested adding only five more books, or ten at the most.[189]

Obviously we should not expect Ammianus to have described events of a hundred to three hundred years before his own time in the same detail as events within living memory. If the foregoing analysis is correct, his main written sources were (1) the very brief obituary chronicle, (2) the *Kaisergeschichte*, which was probably not much longer than the very short histories of Eutropius and Victor, (3) the fairly short history of Herodian, and (4) the probably fairly short history of the pagan Eusebius. Since these sources would have been packed with facts, as the histories of Eutropius and Victor are, the books Ammianus based on them would probably have been similarly concise, except when padded somewhat with digressions. If so, Eustathius and Zonaras would presumably have copied far more from Ammianus on the period from 229 to 337 than on the period from 337 to 364. While Eustathius or Zonaras would have omitted Ammianus' digressions, with the likely exception of the digression on the word "triumph," Eustathius also added considerable information from Christian sources.

We might therefore make the very tentative guess that Zonaras gave about 50% as much space as Ammianus to the years from 229 to 337, rather than around 5%, the percentage Zonaras gave to the years from 353 to 364 and perhaps from 337 to 353. (Admittedly, the estimate of 50% is more or less arbitrary, and scholars who prefer to renumber Ammianus' books can feel free to assume

189 See above, pp. 531–532.

a reduced percentage to fit their hypothesis of five or ten lost books.) Thus Ammianus might have covered the years from 229 to 337 in some four and a half books. From this we might guess that Ammianus' Books I–VI covered the period from 96 to 337 and his Books VII–XIII the period from 337 to 353.[190] Altogether we may have as much as a fifth of the content of Ammianus' first thirteen books in the form of Greek summaries in later historians. This estimate is admittedly approximate and speculative, but perhaps no more so than earlier reconstructions of Ammianus' lost books.

The process of editing fragments of late ancient Latin historians has lagged behind that of editing the much more numerous fragments of late ancient Greek historians. Even if the arguments presented here are wrong, an attempt to collect and edit fragments of the *Kaisergeschichte* would surely help to clarify a wide range of problems. Moreover, even after the publication of two rival editions of the fragments of John of Antioch, it should now be clear that even the longer of the two editions has omitted many relevant fragments from Zonaras, Scutariotes, and several other Byzantine historians, and that these ought to be collected and published as a supplement, if not in a new edition. Of course, if the arguments presented here should be accepted, even if only in substantial part, they would demonstrate the feasibility of an edition of the fragments of Ammianus' lost books, which should include Ammianus' own references to them, most or all of the passages listed in the appendix to this paper, and probably a few additional passages in George the Monk, Symeon the Logothete, Pseudo-Symeon, George Cedrenus, and other Byzantine historians. The results should show that Books I–XIII of Ammianus' history ought to be considered fragmentary rather than lost, and that Ammianus had much more influence on later historiography than has previously been recognized.

190 The content of the books might then have been very roughly as follows: (I) Nerva to Marcus; (II) Commodus to Severus Alexander; (III) Maximinus to Valerian; (IV) Gallienus to Carinus; (V) Diocletian to Constantius I; (VI) Constantine I; (VII) war between Constantine II and Constans; (VIII) war between Constantius II and Sapor II; (IX) usurpation of Magnentius; (X) war between Constantius and Sapor (continued); (XI) submission of Vetranio and appointment of Gallus; (XII) war between Constantius and Magnentius; (XIII) victory of Constantius over Magnentius. Of course, Ammianus mixes different events in different places in Books XIV–XXXI, and he doubtless did the same in Books I–XIII.

Appendix: List of Possible Fragments of Lost Parts of Ammianus' History

For the Period 96–229

- Ages of emperors at their deaths: Malalas X.54 (Nerva), XI.12 (Trajan), XI.20 (Hadrian), XI.27 (Antoninus Pius), XI.33 (Verus), XII.13 (Commodus), XII.14 (Pertinax), XII.17 (Didius Julianus), XII.22 (Septimius Severus), XII.23 (Geta), p. 225 IIb Thurn (Macrinus), and p. 225 IIIc Thurn (Elagabalus) and Scutariotes pp. 30.22 (Nerva), 31.14 (Hadrian), 31.22 (Antoninus Pius), 32.22–23 (Commodus), 32.26 (Pertinax), 32.29 (Didius Julianus), 33.28 (Macrinus), and 34.31 (Elagabalus)

For the Period 229–284

- Reign of Severus Alexander: Zonaras XII.15, pp. 573.1–574.15, John of Antioch fr. 220 (ed. Roberto), and Scutariotes, p. 35.8–16 (at p. 35.16, for λθ′ read κθ′)
- Reigns of Maximinus, Gordian II, Pupienus, and Albinus: Zonaras XII.16–17, pp. 576.5–578.2 and pp. 578.3–580.6, John of Antioch frs. 222–224 (ed. Roberto), and Scutariotes, pp. 35.17–36.16 (at p. 36.11, for ἑξήκοντα read ἑξήκοντα ⟨ἔξ⟩)
- Reigns of Gordian III, Philip, and Decius: Zonaras XII.18–20, pp. 581.17–583.9, pp. 584.1–585.5, and 589.3–14, John of Antioch frs. 225 and 226 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5731, p. 443.3–9, A.M. 5737, p. 444.16–18, and A.M. 5746, p. 459.5–13, and Scutariotes, pp. 36.20–37.10, 37.16–23, and 37.26–30
- Reigns of Gallus, Aemilianus, and Valerian: Zonaras XII.21–23, pp. 589.15–589.22, 589.24–592.5, and 593.3–596.9, John of Antioch frs. 228 and 229 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5746, p. 459.13–17 and A.M. 5748, pp. 465.20–466.23, and Scutariotes, pp. 37.31–38.19
- Reigns of Gallienus, Claudius II, and Quintilianus: Zonaras XII.24–26, pp. 596.15–603.6, and 603.22–606.6, John of Antioch frs. 230–234 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5748, pp. 466.23–467.28 and A.M. 5763, p. 469.17–22, and Scutariotes, pp. 38.20–39.8
- Reigns of Aurelian, Tacitus, Florianus, Probus, Carus, Numerian, and Carinus: Zonaras XII.27–30, pp. 606.7–14 and 607.1–612.7, John of Antioch frs. 235–246 (ed. Roberto), George Syncellus A.M. 5764, pp. 469.25–470.15, A.M. 5765, pp. 470.24–471.3, A.M. 5770, p. 471.11–15, and A.M. 5776, p. 472.9–26, and Scutariotes, pp. 39.9–40.9

For the Period 284–337

- Beginning of Diocletian's reign: Zonaras XII.31, pp. 613.14–614.7, and Scutariotes, p. 40.27–28

- First Tetrarchy: Zonaras XII.31, pp. 614.16–617.14, John of Antioch frs. 247–249 (ed. Roberto), and Scutariotes, p. 41.1–8
- Retirements of Diocletian and Maximian: Zonaras XII.32, pp. 618.4–619.19, John of Antioch frs. 250 and 251.1 (ed. Roberto), and Scutariotes, p. 41.8–12
- Dissolution of Second Tetrarchy: Zonaras XII.33, pp. 621.24–623.2, XIII.1.4, and XIII.21–29, Symeon the Logothete 88.2–3, John of Antioch frs. 252 and 253 (ed. Roberto), and Scutariotes pp. 41.14–42.4
- Reign of Constantine I: Zonaras XIII.4.29–34, George Cedrenus I, pp. 516.12–517.9, and John of Antioch frs. 254 and 255 (ed. Roberto)
- Ages of emperors at their deaths: Malalas XII.44 (Diocletian), XII.46 (Maximian), XII.47 (Galerius, not Maxentius), XII.48 (Constantius I), XII.50 (Maximinus, not Licinius), and XIII.14 (Constantine I; for ξ′ read ξε′ from Zonaras XIII.4.27, Scutariotes p. 43.10–11, Theophanes A.M. 5828, p. 33, Symeon the Logothete 88.1, and George Cedrenus I, p. 520.14)

For the Period 337–353

- Birth and education of Julian: Zonaras XIII.10.2–4
- War between Constantine II and Constans: Zonaras XIII.5.5–16 and Scutariotes, pp. 53.24–54.3
- Constantius II's war with Persia and its background: Zonaras XIII.5.5–6 and XIII.5.17–34
- Usurpation of Magnentius: Zonaras XIII.6 and John of Antioch frs. 257–259 (ed. Roberto)
- Persian siege of Nisibis: Zonaras XIII.7.1–14
- Constantius' war with Magnentius: Zonaras XIII.7.15–8.31
- Constantius' victory over Magnentius: Zonaras XIII.9.1–8 and John of Antioch fr. 260.1–15 (ed. Roberto)
- Ages of emperors at their deaths: Malalas XIII.15 (Constantine II; for κ′ read κδ′) and XIII.16 (Constans) and Zonaras XIII.6.12 (Constans)

For the Period 353–364 (Ammianus XIV–XXV)

- Lacuna after Ammianus XXIV.7.2 (Julian's burning his fleet): Zonaras XIII.13.4–7 and XIII.13.9 and Malalas XIII.22

Acknowledgments

My best thanks go to Thomas Banchich, Timothy Barnes, Michael DiMaio, and Fergus Millar for helpful comments that have improved this article. A short-

ened version of this work was delivered in June 2017 as a lecture to the Oxford Centre for Byzantine Research at the kind invitation of Peter Frankopan.

Bibliography

Anonymus post Dionem, ed. C. Müller (Fragmenta Historicorum Graecorum IV; Paris, 1868).

B. Baldwin, "Eusebius and the Siege of Thessalonica," *Rheinisches Museum für Philologie* 124 (1981): pp. 291–296.

T. Banchich, *The Lost History of Peter the Patrician: An Account of Rome's Imperial Past from the Age of Justinian* (London: Routledge, 2015).

T. Banchich and E. Lane, *The History of Zonaras from Alexander Severus to the Death of Theodosius the Great* (London: Routledge, 2009).

T. Barnes, *Ammianus Marcellinus and the Representation of Historical Reality* (Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 1998).

T. Barnes, *Constantine and Eusebius* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1981).

T. Barnes, *The New Empire of Diocletian and Constantine* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1982).

B. Bleckmann, "Die Chronik des Johannes Zonaras und eine pagane Quelle zur Geschichte Konstantins," *Historia* 40 (1991): pp. 343–365.

B. Bleckmann, *Die Reichskrise des III. Jahrhunderts in der spätantiken und byzantinischen Geschichtsschreibung: Untersuchungen zu den nachdionischen Quellen der Chronik des Johannes Zonaras* (Munich: Tuduv, 1992).

B. Bleckmann, "Magnus von Karrhai: Zur Bedeutung der Malalas-Chronik für die Rekonstruktion der Zeitgeschichte Julians," in L. Carrara et al., *Die Weltchronik des Johannes Malalas: Quellenfragen* (Stuttgart: Franz Steiner Verlag, 2017).

M.F.A. Brok, "Un malentendu tenace (les rapports entre Hérodien et Ammien Marcellin)," *Revue des Études Anciennes* 78/79 (1976/77): pp. 199–207.

R.W. Burgess, "A Common Source for Jerome, Eutropius, Festus, Ammianus, and the Epitome de Caesaribus between 358 and 378, with Further Thoughts on the Date and Nature of the *Kaisergeschichte*," *Classical Philology* 100 (2005): pp. 166–192.

A. Cameron, "Nicomachus Flavianus and the Date of Ammianus' Last Books," *Athenaeum* 100 (2012): pp. 337–358.

A. Cameron, *The Last Pagans of Rome* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2011).

M. DiMaio, *"Infaustis Ductoribus Praeviis*: The Antiochene Connection, Part II," *Byzantion* 51 (1981): pp. 502–510.

M. DiMaio, "Smoke in the Wind: Zonaras' Use of Philostorgius, Zosimus, John of Antioch, and John of Rhodes in his Narrative of the Neo-Flavian Emperors," *Byzantion* 58 (1988): pp. 230–255.

M. DiMaio, "The Antiochene Connection: Zonaras, Ammianus Marcellinus, and John of Antioch on the Reigns of Constantius II and Julian," *Byzantion* 50 (1980): pp. 158–185.

M. DiMaio, "Zonaras, Julian, and Philostorgios on the Death of the Emperor Constantine I," *Greek Orthodox Theological Review* 26 (1981): pp. 118–124.

M. Dodgeon, S. Lieu, *The Roman Eastern Frontier and the Persian Wars, AD 226–363: A Documentary History* (London: Routledge, 1991).

Excerpta Historica iussu imp. Constantini Porphyrogeniti confecta, 4 vols. (Berlin: Apud Weidmannos, 1903–1910).

R. Frakes, "Ammianus and Zonaras on a Late Roman Assassination Plot," *Historia* 46 (1997): pp. 121–128.

R. Frakes, "Some Thoughts on the Length of the Lost Books of Ammianus," *Ancient World* 31 (2000): pp. 48–53.

B. Garstad, "Euhemerus and the Chronicle of John Malalas," *International History Review* 38 (2016): pp. 900–929.

J.F. Gilliam, "Ammianus and the Historia Augusta: The Lost Books and the Period 117–285," in *Bonner Historia-Augusta-Colloquium 1970* (Bonn, 1972): pp. 125–147.

Ioannis Antiocheni Fragmenta ex Historia Chronica, ed. and trans. U. Roberto (Texte und Untersuchungen zur Geschichte der altchristlichen Literatur 154; Berlin: de Gruyter, 2005).

Ioannis Antiocheni Fragmenta quae supersunt Omnia, ed. and trans. S. Mariev (Corpus Fontium Historiae Byzantinae 47; Berlin: de Gruyter, 2008).

P. Janiszewski, *The Missing Link: Greek Pagan Historiography in the Second Half of the Third Century and in the Fourth Century AD* (Warsaw: Warsaw University, 2006).

E. Jeffreys et al., *Studies in John Malalas* (Sydney: University of Sydney, 1990).

A.H.M. Jones, *The Later Roman Empire, 284–602: A Social, Economic, and Administrative Survey* (Oxford: Blackwell, 1964).

G. Kelly, *Ammianus Marcellinus: The Allusive Historian* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2008).

S. Lieu, D. Montserrat, *From Constantine to Julian: Pagan and Byzantine Views: A Source History* (London: Routledge, 1996).

C. Mango and R. Scott, *The Chronicle of Theophanes: Byzantine and Near Eastern History, AD 284–813* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997).

J. Matthews, *The Roman Empire of Ammianus* (Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 1989).

L. Mecella, *Dexippo di Atene: Testimonianze e frammenti* (Tivoli: Edizioni Tored, 2013).

L. Mecella, "Malalas und die Quellen für die Zeit der Soldatenkaiser," in L. Carrara et al., *Die Weltchronik des Johannes Malalas: Quellenfragen* (Stuttgart: Franz Steiner Verlag, 2017): pp. 73–98.

F. Millar, "P. Herrenius Dexippus: The Greek World and the Third-Century Invasions," *Journal of Roman Studies* 59 (1969): pp. 12–29.

E. Patzig, "Über einige Quellen des Zonaras," *Byzantinische Zeitschrift* 5 (1896): pp. 24–53.

E. Patzig, "Über einige Quellen des Zonaras II," *Byzantinische Zeitschrift* 6 (1897): pp. 322–356.

M. Peachin, *Roman Imperial Titulature and Chronology, A.D. 235–284* (Amsterdam: J.C. Gieben, 1990).

Prosopography of the Later Roman Empire I (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1971).

D. Rohrbacher, "The Sources for the Lost Books of Ammianus Marcellinus," *Historia* 55 (2006): pp. 106–124.

H.T. Rowell, "The First Mention of Rome in Ammianus' Extant Books and the Nature of the 'History'," in *Mélanges d'archéologie, d'épigraphie et d'histoire offerts à Jérôme Carcopino* (Paris: Librairie Hachette, 1966): pp. 839–848.

D. Sakel, "Another User of the Lost Source of Scutariotes," *Jahrbuch der Österreichischen Byzantinistik* 62 (2012): pp. 139–144.

D. Sakel, "Codex Patmiacus Graecus 132 and the Chronicle of Scutariotes," in *Atti del X Simposio su S. Giovanni Apostolo*, ed. L. Padovese (Roma: Istituto Francescano di Spiritualità: Pontificia Università Antoniano, 2005): pp. 313–323.

Symeonis Magistri et Logothetae Chronicon I, ed. S. Wahlgren (Berlin: de Gruyter, 2006).

Theodori Scutariotae Chronica, ed. R. Tocci (Corpus Fontium Historiae Byzantinae 66; Berlin: de Gruyter, 2015).

R. Tocci, "Zu Genese und Kompositionsvorgang der Σύνοψις Χρονική des Theodoros Skutariotes," *Byzantinische Zeitschrift* 98 (2005): pp. 551–568.

W. Treadgold, "Predicting the Accession of Theodosius I," *Mediterraneo Antico* 8 (2005): pp. 767–791.

W. Treadgold, "The Byzantine World Histories of John Malalas and Eustathius of Epiphania," *International History Review* 29 (2007): pp. 709–745.

W. Treadgold, *The Early Byzantine Historians* (Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, 2007).

W. Treadgold, *The Middle Byzantine Historians* (Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, 2013).

S. Williams, *Diocletian and the Roman Recovery* (New York: Methuen, 1985).

K. Zafeiris, *The Synopsis Chronike and its Place in the Byzantine Chronicle Tradition: Its Sources (Creation-1081 CE)* (diss. St. Andrews, 2007).